

CLAT Express - September 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Houthi Movement Check

The Houthi movement is an armed group in Yemen that has grown into one of the most powerful forces in the country's long conflict. It began as an opposition movement during the rule of Ali Abdullah Saleh, who had governed North Yemen for many years. The movement's early history is closely tied to a series of wars in Saada, a northern region, which started after the group's founder was killed by Yemeni forces. The 2011 uprising in Yemen, part of the wider Arab Spring, forced Saleh to hand over power to a new leader. The new government then faced an economic crisis and security threats from militant groups, including an al-Qaeda branch that captured territory in parts of the south and east. The Houthis used this instability to expand their territory, moving into the capital and later into western Yemen. Their growth drew a military response from Saudi Arabia, which intervened to restore the internationally recognised government. Today the Houthis remain a central actor in the Yemeni civil war, and their control over key areas shapes regional politics and maritime security along the Red Sea.

Q1.

What is the official name of the Houthi movement?

- (A) Ansar Allah (Supporters of God)
- (B) Ansar al-Sharia
- (C) Al-Hirak
- (D) Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula

Q2.

Which religious group primarily makes up the Houthi movement?

- (A) Sunni Salafists
- (B) Sufi Muslims
- (C) Ismaili Muslims
- (D) Zaidi Shia Muslims

Q3.

Who was the founder of the Houthi movement?

- (A) Abdul-Malik al-Houthi
- (B) Ali Abdullah Saleh
- (C) Rashad al-Alimi
- (D) Hussein al-Houthi

Q4.

Read the two statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Saudi Arabia launched a military intervention in Yemen in 2015 after the Houthi takeover.

Reason (R): The Houthis claimed responsibility for a missile attack on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Hussein al-Houthi	A. Deputy who took over from Saleh
II. Abdul-Malik al-Houthi	B. President of Yemen
III. Abdrabbuh Mansour Hadi	C. Current leader of the movement
IV. Rashad al-Alimi	D. Founder of the movement

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Houthi movement:

- I. The Houthis oppose Israel and the United States.
- II. The Houthis are primarily composed of Sunni Salafists.
- III. The Houthis are part of the Iranian-led Axis of Resistance.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Houthi movement are correct?

- I. The Houthis claimed responsibility for a missile attack on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport.
- II. The Houthis captured Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport.
- III. The Saada Wars began in 2004 after the founder was killed.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

In which year did the Houthis capture Sanaa, forcing President Hadi to flee abroad in 2015?

- (A) 2018
- (B) 2011
- (C) 2017
- (D) 2014

Indus Waters Treaty: MCQ practice

The Indus Waters Treaty is a bilateral agreement between India and Pakistan that governs how the waters of the Indus river system are shared. The treaty divides the rivers into two groups. One group is available to one country with broad rights, while the other group is mainly allocated to the other country, which keeps only limited uses such as domestic supply, some irrigation and power generation from run-of-river plants. The agreement also sets out a layered system for resolving disputes, which runs from bilateral discussion to more formal procedures. Recently, a tribunal based in The Hague held that India cannot suspend the treaty by placing it in abeyance, and that the treaty remains in force. India rejected the ruling. New Delhi says the tribunal was not properly formed and has no jurisdiction over its sovereign decisions, so it has neither recognised the

tribunal nor taken part in its proceedings. The episode has renewed debate about how the treaty's dispute procedures should work, especially when both countries pursue parallel proceedings.

Q1.

Which organisation facilitated the Indus Waters Treaty?

- (A) United Nations
- (B) International Court of Justice
- (C) International Monetary Fund
- (D) World Bank

Q2.

Under the Indus Waters Treaty, India has exclusive and unrestricted use of which rivers?

- (A) Ravi, Beas and Sutlej
- (B) Indus, Jhelum and Chenab
- (C) Indus, Ravi and Beas
- (D) Jhelum, Chenab and Sutlej

Q3.

Which article of the Indus Waters Treaty states that the treaty continues in force until terminated by a duly ratified treaty?

- (A) Article III(1)
- (B) Article VIII
- (C) Article IX
- (D) Article XII(4)

Q4.

Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are given below.

Assertion (A): The Court of Arbitration did not accept cross-border terrorism as a material breach of the treaty by Pakistan.

Reason (R): The Indus Waters Treaty contains no provisions dealing with terrorism or use of force.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Permanent Indus Commission	A. Exclusive and unrestricted use for India
II. Neutral Expert	B. Meets at least once a year
III. Court of Arbitration	C. Handles technical differences
IV. Eastern rivers (Ravi, Beas, Sutlej)	D. Constituted under Annexure G

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the dispute-resolution mechanism of the Indus Waters Treaty:

- I. The Permanent Indus Commission is the first institutional mechanism for addressing questions between India and Pakistan.
- II. Technical differences that the Commission cannot resolve may be referred to a Neutral Expert.
- III. The Court of Arbitration is constituted under Annexure G and has three members.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Indus Waters Treaty and the Court of Arbitration ruling:

- I. The treaty contains provisions dealing with terrorism.
- II. The treaty continues in force until terminated by a duly ratified treaty for that purpose.
- III. India participated in the Court of Arbitration proceedings.
- IV. Interim restrictions on the Ratle project last until 90 days after the Neutral Expert's final decision.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only two

Q8.

The Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties is popularly known as the:

- (A) Treaty on Treaties
- (B) Charter of Agreements
- (C) Law of Nations
- (D) Code of Pacts

Cardiff Pact MCQ set

Political leaders from Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland signed a Memorandum of Understanding in Cardiff, asserting the principle of self-determination and calling for constitutional changes within the United Kingdom. The move has renewed debate over the UK's devolution framework, under which power is transferred from the central government to subnational institutions while ultimate constitutional authority stays at the centre. Devolution in the UK is asymmetric, because the extent and nature of devolved powers differ among the territories. The pact is a political understanding rather than a legally binding treaty. It asks Westminster to prepare, plan and facilitate constitutional change, and it affirms each nation's right to hold independence referendums. The UK government has rejected demands for new independence referendums, saying such votes need appropriate constitutional and legal authority. In the 2016 Brexit referendum, Scotland and Northern Ireland both voted to remain in the EU, which fed into these debates. Scotland and Wales would seek EU membership as new states, while Northern Ireland would rejoin the EU through unification with the Republic of Ireland. The pact is seen as the most coordinated challenge to the UK's union structure since the Good Friday Agreement.

Q1.

Which Sinn Fein leader signed the Cardiff Pact for Northern Ireland?

- (A) Mary Lou McDonald
- (B) Arlene Foster
- (C) Gerry Adams
- (D) Michelle O'Neill

Q2.

Rhun ap Iorwerth, a signatory of the pact, represents which party?

- (A) Democratic Unionist Party
- (B) Sinn Fein
- (C) Scottish National Party
- (D) Plaid Cymru

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Scotland Act 1998	A. Regulates the domestic UK market after Brexit
II. Government of Wales Act 1998	B. Signed on 10 April 1998 at Belfast
III. Good Friday Agreement	C. Established the Scottish Parliament
IV. UK Internal Market Act 2020	D. Established the Welsh Legislature, now Senedd

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q4.

Statements about the Cardiff Pact and the UK:

- I. The Cardiff Pact was signed by leaders from Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland.
- II. The Good Friday Agreement was signed in Cardiff in 1998.
- III. The Barnett Formula is used by the UK Treasury to set changes in block grant funding for devolved administrations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Good Friday Agreement are correct?

- I. It was signed at Cardiff in 1998.
 - II. It allows citizens of Northern Ireland to hold Irish or British citizenship or both.
 - III. It allows reunification with Ireland to be sought at any time, subject to a referendum.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None of the above

Q6.

In the 2016 Brexit referendum, what percentage of Northern Ireland voted to Remain?

- (A) 70%
- (B) 62%
- (C) 48%
- (D) 55.8%

Q7.

The Act of Union that brought Ireland into the United Kingdom was passed in which year?

- (A) 1536
- (B) 1707
- (C) 1922
- (D) 1801

Act provisions check

Russia's war in Ukraine has prompted the United States to enact a law that increases economic pressure on Russia, while also extending and strengthening certain sanctions against Iran. The statute, named after Lindsey O. Graham, is built around criteria that decide which buyers of Russian energy fall within its reach. The law gives the executive branch several trade tools, including tariffs on the largest buyers of Russian oil and natural gas and tariffs on goods of Russian origin. Because the list of relevant buyers can change over time, the law provides for a periodic review carried out by the trade representative. Countries that rely only lightly on Russian gas, and that are actively cutting their imports, may qualify for a special exception. The framework's effect is also conditional, since it may be affected if Russia meets certain conditions linked to peace in Ukraine and to the stance of the Ukrainian government. For India, the measure is especially relevant because the country remains one of the major buyers of Russian crude, so Indian policymakers must weigh energy security against trade relations with the United States. Its economic effects would depend on how the tariffs are applied and how buyers respond.

Q1.

Compared with the original proposal, what is the enacted tariff ceiling for the largest purchasers of Russian oil and gas?

- (A) Reduced to 100%
- (B) Raised to 1000%
- (C) Unchanged at 500%
- (D) Removed entirely

Q2.

Assertion (A): India is significantly affected by the Act even though the law names no individual country.

Reason (R): Its criteria place major buyers of Russian crude like India within its regulatory scope.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Reassessment of relevant purchasers	A. Top 5 facilitators
II. Tariffs on facilitators of Russian oil sanctions evasion	B. Up to 500% on Russian-origin goods
III. Tariffs on Russian-origin goods	C. Through 2031
IV. Extension of Iran Sanctions Act of 1996	D. 180-day review cycle

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Act:

- I. It authorises tariffs of up to 500% on Russian-origin goods, subject to specified exceptions.
- II. The U.S. Trade Representative must reassess relevant purchasers on a 90-day review cycle.
- III. A country importing less than 15% of its natural gas from Russia can qualify for an exception if it takes significant steps to reduce such imports.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Act are correct?

- A. The House of Representatives passed the Act by 262 votes to 159 on 16 September 2026.
 - B. The Act extends the Iran Sanctions Act of 1996 through 2031.
 - C. The President signed the Act into law on 16 September 2026.
 - D. The Act names India directly as a country subject to its tariffs.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) None

Q6.

Under the new Act, a presidential waiver requires:

- (A) Consent from the target country
- (B) A Supreme Court order
- (C) Approval from the UN Security Council
- (D) Formal justification to Congress

Q7.

In February 2026, what did the U.S. Supreme Court do to the broader tariff regime that included the earlier 25% punitive tariff on India?

- (A) Upheld it
- (B) Extended it
- (C) Referred it to Congress
- (D) Struck it down

Q8.

The use of tariffs and sanctions to influence the behaviour of third countries is known as:

- (A) Secondary sanctions
- (B) Primary sanctions
- (C) Trade embargo
- (D) Anti-dumping measures

Joint Commission: Practice MCQs

Pakistan and China have set up a Boundary Joint Commission to watch over how their border management arrangements are put into practice. The body is meant to help the two sides coordinate on the everyday business of a shared frontier, including joint surveys, the flow of trade across the boundary and ties between people on either side. Its roots lie in an earlier bilateral framework on managing the boundary, which laid the groundwork for the new institution. The arrangement has drawn a firm response from India, which maintains that the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh are integral parts of the country. New Delhi has questioned the move and reaffirmed its own claims over the territory concerned. The dispute centres on the Shaksgam Valley, a mountainous stretch in the Karakoram region, which came under a boundary agreement signed in the 1960s. Routes and infrastructure that link Xinjiang with Pakistan add to the importance of the arrangement, because they strengthen connectivity in a sensitive part of the western Himalayas. India therefore reads the Commission as part of a wider pattern of China-Pakistan coordination close to its own northern frontiers.

Q1.

The Pakistan-China Boundary Joint Commission was operationalised in which month and city (inaugural meeting)?

- (A) September 2026, Islamabad
- (B) September 2026, Beijing
- (C) March 2026, Islamabad
- (D) September 2026, Kashgar

Q2.

The Boundary Joint Commission originates from which agreement?

- (A) 1963 China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement
- (B) 2005 CBM Protocol
- (C) 1996 Confidence-Building Measures Agreement
- (D) 2013 Pakistan-China Agreement on Boundary Management System

Q3.

Assertion (A): India has rejected the Pakistan-China Joint Commission insofar as it concerns territory India claims.

Reason (R): Pakistan has no locus standi to enter into arrangements involving territory India regards as under Pakistan's illegal occupation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Khunjerab Crossing	A. Supervises implementation of border management arrangements
II. Shaksgam Valley	B. Connects Kashgar in Xinjiang with Gwadar Port
III. China-Pakistan Economic Corridor	C. Area ceded by Pakistan to China under the 1963 agreement
IV. Boundary Joint Commission	D. Principal overland connection between China and Pakistan

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the 1963 China-Pakistan Boundary Agreement:

- I. It was signed on 2 March 1963.
- II. India has recognised it as legally valid.
- III. Pakistan transferred approximately 5,180 sq km of Shaksgam Valley to China.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I only
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Shaksgam Valley are correct?

- I. It lies north of the Siachen Glacier in the Karakoram region.
- II. It is located in Arunachal Pradesh.
- III. India has accepted the 1963 agreement over it.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

The China-Pakistan Economic Corridor connects Kashgar in Xinjiang with which port?

- (A) Karachi
- (B) Chabahar
- (C) Hambantota
- (D) Gwadar

Q8.

Which crossing is the principal overland connection between China and Pakistan?

- (A) Khunjerab
- (B) Nathu La
- (C) Shipki La
- (D) Lipulekh

Properties of map projections

Every world map is an attempt to show a curved surface on a flat sheet, and that task cannot be done without some loss. The Earth is not a perfect sphere, and its surface is curved in every direction. Cartographers therefore use map projections, which are systematic rules for transferring the globe onto a plane. No single flat map can keep every feature of the globe correct at the same time. Mapmakers must choose which properties to protect, such as the size of landmasses, the shapes of countries, the distances between places, or the directions between them. Some maps are made to guide travellers at sea, while others serve thematic and statistical purposes, such as showing population density. A projection that works well for one purpose may mislead when used for another. Over time, different projections have been developed, each built around a different choice of property. Readers should therefore check which property a map keeps accurate before drawing conclusions about the world from its outlines. The choice of projection is a practical decision rather than a search for one perfect map.

Q1.

Which property do equal-area projections preserve?

- (A) Relative areas
- (B) Distances
- (C) Angles
- (D) Directions

Q2.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Mercator projection was introduced in 1569.
- II. The Equal Earth projection was created in 1973.
- III. The Gall-Peters projection was first presented in 1855.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Mercator projection is a cylindrical and conformal projection.
- II. The Equal Earth projection preserves relative areas.
- III. The Robinson projection preserves area exactly.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Mercator projection preserves local shapes.

Reason (R): On the Mercator grid, the stretching of parallels is matched exactly with the stretching of meridians.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Gall-Peters projection	A. Devised to balance size and shape
II. Robinson projection	B. Created in 1921 by a German cartographer
III. Winkel Tripel projection	C. Created in 2018
IV. Equal Earth projection	D. First presented in 1855

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Which projection replaced Robinson in National Geographic Society maps in 1998?

- (A) Mercator
- (B) Gall-Peters
- (C) Equal Earth
- (D) Winkel Tripel

Q7.

The Earth is described as an oblate spheroid rather than a perfect sphere because of:

- (A) Its rotation and uneven distribution of mass
- (B) Its tilted axis
- (C) Its orbit around the Sun
- (D) Tidal effects of the Moon

Q8.

In which year was the Mercator projection introduced?

- (A) 1855
- (B) 1921
- (C) 1963
- (D) 1569

CEC Appointment and Removal: MCQ Set

The Election Commission of India is a constitutional body, placed under Part XV of the Constitution, that administers elections to Parliament, the State Legislatures, and the offices of President and Vice President. Its job is to ensure free and fair elections across the country. Since 1993, it has functioned as a three-member body, with one Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and two Election Commissioners (ECs). Earlier, the President made these appointments on the advice of the Prime Minister. In *Anoop Baranwal vs Union of India* (2023), a five-judge bench directed that the CEC and ECs be appointed on the advice of a Selection Committee. Parliament then passed the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 to comply with that directive. Under the Act, the Selection Committee consists of the Prime Minister, a Union Cabinet Minister and the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha. A Search Committee, headed by the Minister of Law and Justice, prepares a panel of names for the Selection Committee to consider. The Opposition has recently announced plans to move a motion in Parliament seeking the removal of the CEC. This has drawn fresh attention to the constitutional safeguards that govern the independence and removal of the CEC.

Q1.

Assertion (A): Under Article 326, the right to vote is a fundamental right of every adult citizen.

Reason (R): In Kuldip Nayar vs Union of India (2006), the Supreme Court held that the right to vote is statutory, not fundamental.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 325	A. Supervisory and controlling authority over elections and electoral rolls
II. Article 326	B. No exclusion from electoral rolls on grounds of religion, race, caste or sex
III. Article 324	C. Authority to act independently where laws are silent
IV. Articles 327 & 328	D. Adult suffrage

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q3.

The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023 replaced which earlier Act?

- (A) Representation of the People Act, 1950
- (B) Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961
- (C) Election Commission Act, 1985
- (D) Election Commission (Conditions of Service of Election Commissioners and Transaction of Business) Act, 1991

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the CEC and ECs:

- I. The CEC and ECs enjoy salary and benefits equal to a Supreme Court Judge.
- II. The CEC is eligible for re-appointment after completing a six-year term.
- III. If an EC is appointed as CEC, the combined term as EC and CEC must not exceed six years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the appointment process are correct?

- I. The Search Committee proposes a panel of five names.
- II. The Selection Committee can consider names beyond the shortlist.
- III. The Selection Committee cannot function while there are vacancies.

- (A) None
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

Q6.

Which case is regarded as a cornerstone in defining the plenary powers of the ECI under Article 324?

- (A) Mohinder Singh Gill v. Chief Election Commissioner (1977)
- (B) Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala
- (C) Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India
- (D) S.R. Bommai v. Union of India

Q7.

National Voters' Day is celebrated on which date to mark the foundation of the Election Commission of India?

- (A) 26 January
- (B) 25 November
- (C) 15 August
- (D) 25 January

Q8.

Who was the first woman CEC, known for the shortest tenure of 16 days?

- (A) V.S. Ramadevi
- (B) Meera Kumar
- (C) Sushma Swaraj
- (D) Vasundhara Raje

Programme 2.0 and Its Pillars

Semiconductors have become central to modern life because they power automobiles, hospitals, defence systems, aircraft, telecom networks and a wide range of consumer goods. Modern chips can hold billions of transistors within very small areas, which makes them essential for high-performance computing, artificial intelligence and digital services. Semiconductors sit at the base of the global electronics industry, a very large economic sector. The COVID-19 pandemic showed how risky it is when chip production is concentrated in a few places, and many countries have since tried to build their own capabilities. India's response is a national programme that seeks to build a complete semiconductor ecosystem, covering design, fabrication, packaging, research and skilled manpower. Its purpose is to give the sector financial and infrastructure support, so that domestic companies can grow and compete. The government hopes this will make India a dependable partner in the global value chain, in line with the vision of self-reliance and manufacturing for the world. Several areas of the programme are meant to move forward together, so that progress in design, equipment, factories and people keeps pace with one another.

Q1.

In which month and year was Semicon India Programme 2.0 approved?

- (A) July 2026
- (B) January 2026
- (C) December 2021
- (D) September 2025

Q2.

What is the enhanced outlay of Semicon India Programme 2.0?

- (A) Rs 50,000 crore
- (B) Rs 1,00,000 crore
- (C) Rs 2,00,000 crore
- (D) Rs 1,27,500 crore

Q3.

How many semiconductor projects have been approved across 6 States under Programme 2.0?

- (A) 12
- (B) 6
- (C) 10
- (D) 15

Q4.

Assertion (A): Semicon India Programme 2.0 is intended to support the semiconductor sector only for a short period.

Reason (R): It is a comprehensive, macro-level national policy framework that provides sustained, long-term financial and infrastructure support.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Chips to Startup Programme	A. Support for over 5 years
II. Design-Linked Incentive Scheme	B. Incentives based on incremental sales
III. Production Linked Incentive Scheme	C. Established at C-DAC
IV. ChipIN Centre	D. Access to EDA tools for academic institutions

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Semicon India Programme 2.0:

- I. Talent development is one of its six key pillars.
- II. It was launched in 2021 along with the original programme.
- III. Advanced packaging is one of its six key pillars.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Under which two programmes was the ChipIN Centre at C-DAC established?

- (A) PLI Scheme and iCET
- (B) Pax Silica and ISM 2.0
- (C) Semicon Programme 1.0 and PLI Scheme
- (D) C2S Programme and DLI Scheme

Framework and rules check

The Unified Payments Interface has grown into a large digital payment network that handles billions of transactions every month. Running such a network requires continuous spending on technology, cybersecurity, fraud prevention, server capacity and customer support. Until now, merchants have not paid any fee for UPI and RuPay transactions, which helped small businesses

and informal sectors adopt digital payments. As the network expands, however, planners must decide how its upkeep should be funded. The answer proposed in the new framework is a fee on certain merchant payments, while everyday low-value transactions remain free. Officials have stressed that small merchants and ordinary users should not face additional costs. The fee is therefore aimed at larger merchant payments rather than at the many small transactions that make up daily life. Such a structure lets the payment ecosystem generate revenue that supports its own operation. Policymakers have sought a balance between funding the network and protecting the people who use it every day. UPI works in real time and around the clock, connecting individuals and merchants across banks. Its wide use has made it an important part of commerce for individuals and merchants alike. Because so many people rely on it, any change to how the network is priced affects a very large number of users and businesses.

Q1.

From which date does the new MDR framework on UPI transactions come into effect?

- (A) 15 October 2026
- (B) 1 April 2026
- (C) 1 January 2027
- (D) 15 August 2026

Q2.

What MDR rate applies to eligible merchant UPI transactions in the mid-value slab?

- (A) 0.02%
- (B) 1%
- (C) 2%
- (D) 0.4%

Q3.

In which year was the zero-MDR policy for UPI and RuPay transactions introduced?

- (A) 2020
- (B) 2016
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2022

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mutual funds, securities, stock brokers and stock dealers	A. MDR capped at ₹300 per transaction
II. Transactions of ₹75,000 and above	B. Exempt from MDR
III. Railways, telecom, insurance, fuel, agricultural inputs (above ₹2,000)	C. Reduced MDR of 0.02%
IV. Person-to-person (P2P) UPI transactions	D. Flat MDR of ₹5 per transaction

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the new MDR framework:

- I. The framework applies to eligible P2M UPI transactions above ₹2,000.
- II. Small merchants receiving up to ₹1 lakh per month through UPI QR codes under the P2PM category remain exempt from MDR.
- III. MDR is a tax collected by the government, and its revenue goes to the RBI.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about NPCI:

- I. NPCI is an umbrella organisation for operating and developing retail payment and settlement systems in India.
- II. NPCI is a Section 8 company under the Companies Act 2013.
- III. NPCI's headquarters is in Jaipur.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

In which city is the headquarters of the National Payments Corporation of India located?

- (A) Jaipur
- (B) New Delhi
- (C) Bengaluru
- (D) Mumbai

Finance, Trade and Customs MCQs

Financial and trade cooperation was among the most detailed areas of the 18th BRICS Summit, which India hosted in New Delhi in 2026. Member countries discussed how cross-border trade could be made less vulnerable to currency swings and to disruptions in global financial markets. A dedicated risk-focused initiative was also discussed, linked to large infrastructure projects across the Global South and to the geopolitical risks that such projects carry. Small enterprises received particular attention, since many of them need steady cash flow to run their operations and compete in international markets. Support for young companies also formed part of the discussions. On the tax and customs side, the summit focused on sharing knowledge between national tax authorities and on joint action against smuggling and illicit financial flows, while stressing that genuine trade should continue without unnecessary obstruction. The conversations also highlighted the role of new technologies and digital solutions for development. The overall message was that a more resilient financial architecture would help developing economies manage external shocks while keeping trade flowing.

Q1.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The BRICS Risk Lab is located in Mumbai.
- II. The BRICS Startup Innovation Fund was proposed to support early-stage ventures.
- III. The BRICS Tax Cross-Learning Lab was launched at the summit.
- IV. The BRICS Payment Task Force seeks trade settlements in US dollars.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q2.

Which action plan was launched along with the BRICS Tax Cross-Learning Lab?

- (A) Authorised Economic Operator Action Plan 2026
- (B) Sustainable Aviation Fuels Forum
- (C) Global Value Chains Action Plan 2026-2030
- (D) Joint Roadmap for Healthy Lifestyle Promotion

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The BRICS Risk Lab is located in GIFT City, Gujarat.
- II. The Jaipur Consensus on MSME Financing helps MSMEs convert unpaid invoices into working capital.
- III. The BRICS Payment Task Force seeks to facilitate trade settlements in US dollars.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q4.

In which place is the BRICS Risk Lab located?

- (A) Mumbai
- (B) Nagpur, Maharashtra
- (C) Gurugram, Haryana
- (D) GIFT City, Gujarat

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. BRICS Risk Lab	A. Support for early-stage ventures
II. Jaipur Consensus	B. Strengthening reinsurance capabilities
III. BRICS Startup Innovation Fund	C. Trade settlements through local currencies
IV. BRICS Payment Task Force	D. Unpaid invoices into working capital

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

The Jaipur Consensus on MSME Financing is intended to help MSMEs convert which of the following into working capital?

- (A) Unpaid invoices
- (B) Fixed deposits
- (C) Export licences
- (D) Government grants

Q7.

Through which currencies does the BRICS Payment Task Force seek to facilitate trade settlements?

- (A) Local currencies
- (B) US dollars
- (C) Gold
- (D) Cryptocurrency

26th SCO Summit: MCQ set

The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation has grown from a regional grouping into a wide Eurasian platform that links Central Asia, South Asia, China, Russia and Iran. Its work covers regional security, counter-terrorism, economic and connectivity cooperation, political dialogue, and cultural and people-to-people exchanges. Its leaders meet every year, and the host state rotates along with the chairmanship. The latest summit was held in Bishkek, the capital of Kyrgyzstan, and was chaired by the country's president. The gathering marked the organisation's 25th anniversary, and its theme focused on sustainable peace, development and prosperity. Leaders reviewed a large set of outcome documents on security, economy, energy, climate, institutional development and culture. The summit also reaffirmed the need for collective action against terrorism and adopted the main political document of the meeting. The summit also dealt with new mechanisms against drug trafficking and the financing of extremism, which the organisation treats as shared regional threats. A standing regional structure for counter-terrorism frames terror financing and radicalisation as collective concerns. The agenda also includes transport corridors and payment arrangements. Such a summit shows how the SCO tries to balance security concerns with its economic goals, while giving member states a common forum for their policies. It is a useful window into the organisation's priorities.

Q1.

The SCO Secretariat, the permanent administrative body of the organisation, is located in which city?

- (A) Tashkent
- (B) Bishkek
- (C) Moscow
- (D) Beijing

Q2.

In which year did Iran become a full member of the SCO?

- (A) 2017
- (B) 2021
- (C) 2023
- (D) 2024

Q3.

Which document was adopted as the principal political document of the 26th SCO Summit?

- (A) Bishkek Declaration
- (B) New Delhi Declaration
- (C) Tashkent Declaration
- (D) Shanghai Declaration

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Council of Heads of State is the highest decision-making body of the SCO.

Reason (R): The Council of Heads of Government focuses on economic and developmental cooperation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Shanghai Five created	A. 2023
II. SCO Charter signed	B. 2024
III. Iran became a full member	C. 2002
IV. Belarus became a full member	D. 1996

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the SCO:

- I. The Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure is based in Tashkent.
- II. The SCO was formally established on 15 June 2001 in Shanghai.
- III. India became a full member of the SCO in 2005.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the 26th SCO Summit:

- The summit was held from 31 August to 1 September 2026.
- Narendra Modi represented India at the summit.
- Kassym-Jomart Tokayev chaired the summit.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) None
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

Q8.

Which city has been designated SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital for 2026-27?

- (A) Cholpon-Ata
- (B) Samarkand
- (C) Bishkek
- (D) Lahore

UNGA, P4M and India's Stand

The 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly opened on 8 September 2026 in New York, under the theme 'Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: A United Nations That Delivers for All.' On its sidelines, India's External Affairs Minister co-chaired the inaugural Partners for Multilateralism, International Law, Peace and Prosperity (P4M) Summit with European Council President Antonio Costa. The P4M framework is built upon the Carney Doctrine on middle-power solidarity, which Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney delivered at Davos. The initiative was conceived in response to the erosion of global consensus, trade weaponisation and escalating conflicts across Europe and West Asia. It was conceptualised by leaders of the European Union, Brazil, Kenya and Canada, and is co-sponsored by India, Australia and Barbados. It is designed as an open and flexible framework rather than another exclusive international bloc or permanent bureaucracy. It seeks to strengthen international law, peace, multilateral cooperation and inclusive prosperity, and to enable countries from different political traditions to cooperate on reforming multilateral institutions and addressing common global challenges. Meanwhile, India used the same period of diplomacy to argue for reformed multilateralism, stressing risks to supply chains, the need for more inclusive decision-making and comprehensive reform of the United Nations Security Council.

Q1.

India's 4F crisis refers to disruptions involving which four areas?

- (A) Fuel, Food, Fertiliser, Finance
- (B) Fuel, Fibre, Forest, Finance
- (C) Food, Fertiliser, Freight, Farming
- (D) Finance, Fintech, Fuel, Fisheries

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Arctic Council	A. Expedition of Hans Egede arrived in 1721
II. Visegrad Group (V4)	B. Established in 1996 (Ottawa Declaration)
III. Pituffik Space Base	C. Established in 1991
IV. Greenland as a Danish colony	D. Formerly known as Thule Air Base

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India called for international frameworks and guardrails for AI, space security and digital technologies.
- II. India pursued UNSC reform through the G7 and G20 groupings.
- III. India highlighted the disproportionate impact of 4F disruptions on developing countries.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Visegrad Group was established in 1991.
- II. The Visegrad Group takes its name from a town in Hungary.
- III. The Arctic Council was established in 2001 through the Ottawa Declaration.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the statements

Q5.

Who is the current chair of the Arctic Council for 2025-2027?

- (A) Denmark
- (B) Canada
- (C) Norway
- (D) Russia

Q6.

At the V4 plus India meeting, the V4 unanimously supported India's candidature for which status?

- (A) Membership of the G7
- (B) Chairmanship of the Arctic Council
- (C) Permanent membership of the UN Security Council
- (D) Membership of the European Union

Reading the Index

Gender equality is often discussed in terms of laws and policies, but measuring it is a separate challenge. One widely cited tool is the Global Gender Gap Index, which is published every year as a flagship report. Its purpose is not simply to count how many women hold particular positions. Instead, it asks how far each country has moved toward closing the disparities between women and men. This focus on gaps rather than absolute outcomes shapes the whole report. Each country receives a numerical score, and these scores allow nations to be compared on a common yardstick. One end of the range signals complete equality, while the other end signals absolute inequality. The scores can also be presented on a more familiar scale, where the highest value stands for full parity. Because the report is repeated each year, observers can see whether countries are moving forward or falling behind. Readers should remember that a ranking captures relative progress among the countries covered. It does not, by itself, describe the daily experience of women in any single society. Understanding the method behind the scores is therefore as important as reading the final table.

Q1.

Which country retained the first position for the 17th consecutive year?

- (A) Finland
- (B) Norway
- (C) Iceland
- (D) Sweden

Q2.

In which year was the Global Gender Gap Report introduced?

- (A) 2006
- (B) 1971
- (C) 2000
- (D) 2015

Q3.

Consider the following statements about the Global Gender Gap Report:

- I. The report was introduced in 2006.
- II. The report was introduced in 2015.
- III. The report is an annual flagship publication of the World Economic Forum.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q4.

Assertion (A): The World Economic Forum was founded by Klaus Schwab in 1971.

Reason (R): The World Economic Forum is a Switzerland-based think tank and advocacy group.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

The 2026 Global Gender Gap Report is which edition?

- (A) 10th
- (B) 15th
- (C) 20th
- (D) 25th

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the index's dimensions are correct?

- I. Economic Participation and Opportunity is one of its dimensions.
- II. Educational Attainment is one of its dimensions.
- III. Social Security Coverage is one of its dimensions.
- IV. Political Empowerment is one of its dimensions.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

How many countries does the 2026 index cover?

- (A) 135
- (B) 148
- (C) 146
- (D) 145

Sarvekshan rankings check

The Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan is an annual assessment of the cities covered under the National Clean Air Programme. It was first launched in 2022-23. The cities are grouped into three categories according to their population: Category I covers the largest cities, Category II covers mid-sized cities and Category III covers the smallest cities in the assessment. The assessment focuses on seven areas of measures: road dust management, solid waste management, vehicular emissions, industrial emissions, construction and demolition waste, commercial sources, and public awareness and outreach initiatives. Cities are evaluated on five key parameters: ambient air quality, source apportionment, action plan implementation, institutional capacity and public participation. Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026 was observed on 7 September 2026, which coincides with the International Day

of Clean Air for Blue Skies. The fifth set of Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan Awards was presented on that occasion. The awards recognise cities and wards that have shown effective air pollution mitigation measures under the programme. The 2026 edition also introduced a new feature: ward-level rankings, which show how individual wards compare with one another. City-level results are reported within each category, which means cities are compared with others of similar population.

Q1.

How many of the following statements about the 5th Sarvekshan rankings are correct?

- I. Indore secured the 2nd position in Category I.
- II. Angul secured the 1st position in Category III.
- III. Rourkela secured the 1st position in Category II.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q2.

Which two cities shared the second position in Category II (population 3-10 lakh)?

- (A) Firozabad and Guntur
- (B) Rourkela and Amravati
- (C) Indore and Jabalpur
- (D) Angul and Talcher

Q3.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- I. Lucknow was the top-performing city in Category I (population above 10 lakh).
- II. Jabalpur secured the second position in Category I (population above 10 lakh).
- III. Talcher secured the third position in Category III (population below 3 lakh).

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Which city secured the 2nd position in Category I (population above 10 lakh) in the 5th Sarvekshan 2026?

- (A) Lucknow
- (B) Jabalpur
- (C) Indore
- (D) Kota

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Category I (population above 10 lakh)	A. Amravati
II. Category II (population 3-10 lakh)	B. Kalinganagar
III. Category III (population below 3 lakh)	C. Rourkela
IV. Category II, third position	D. Lucknow

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Which city was ranked 30th in Category I of the 5th Sarvekshan 2026?

- (A) Delhi
- (B) Jabalpur
- (C) Indore
- (D) Lucknow

Q7.

Which city was the leading performer in Category III (population below 3 lakh)?

- (A) Angul
- (B) Talcher
- (C) Rourkela
- (D) Kalinganagar

EOS-05 launch and imaging check

Earth observation satellites help governments see what is happening on the ground without sending anyone to the site. ISRO has added a new satellite to this list, known in the booklet as EOS-05 and also called GISAT-1A. The satellite was lifted into space by an indigenous heavy-lift rocket from an Indian launch centre, and the mission is treated as a test of the country's launch capability. The spacecraft is described as an advanced Earth observation satellite meant for continuous and high-frequency imagery. Such imagery supports disaster response, border watch and farm monitoring. As the booklet notes, the choice of orbit determines geographical coverage, image resolution, revisit time and the mission application. The same imagery can help plan emergency responses and track weather events. The sections that follow describe the satellite, the orbit it uses and the other missions that share its theme. Students preparing for competitive examinations should note that such questions usually test the specific numbers, stages and names attached to a mission, since these details are easy to confuse.

Q1.

Which launch vehicle carried EOS-05 into orbit?

- (A) PSLV-C60
- (B) LVM3-M4
- (C) GSLV-F17
- (D) SSLV-D3

Q2.

What is the approximate mass of EOS-05?

- (A) 1,200 kg
- (B) 3,500 kg
- (C) 4,000 kg
- (D) 2,367 kg

Q3.

Assertion (A): EOS-05 can monitor large geographical areas persistently.

Reason (R): It operates from a sub-geosynchronous orbit at about 35,786 km, the altitude of geosynchronous orbit.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Medium Earth Orbit	A. Appears fixed over one point of Earth
II. Very Low Earth Orbit	B. Relatively consistent solar illumination
III. Geostationary Orbit	C. Very high resolution, greater atmospheric drag
IV. Sun-Synchronous Orbit	D. Used by GNSS such as GPS and Galileo

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the GSLV-F17 launch of EOS-05.

- I. The satellite was launched from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota.
- II. GSLV-F17 marked the 19th operational flight of the GSLV.
- III. The third stage of GSLV-F17 is a solid-propellant stage.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about EOS-05 are correct?

- I. It is designed to carry only radar imaging instruments.
- II. It is designed for operations from a sub-geosynchronous orbit about 35,786 km above Earth.
- III. It carries optical and infrared imaging payloads.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

What is the nickname of EOS-05?

- (A) Naughty Boy
- (B) Sky Watcher
- (C) Vayu Netra
- (D) Eye in the Sky

Q8.

Why is GEO-based Earth observation useful compared with LEO?

- (A) It provides persistent, wide-area monitoring instead of intermittent passes
- (B) It offers higher resolution than LEO
- (C) It uses less fuel
- (D) It has lower communication delay

Disputes at Sea, Land and Lake

Several disputes over sea, land and naming drew attention this month. A Pakistani naval vessel, PNS Hunain, collided with the Indian Navy warship INS Kolkata in the North Arabian Sea. India described the conduct of the Pakistani vessel as unsafe, said the incident took place in international waters, and lodged a diplomatic protest. The episode became both a maritime and a diplomatic

dispute. A similar collision had taken place in the Gulf of Aden in June 2011, involving INS Godavari and PNS Babur.

The two countries already have a bilateral agreement from 1991 that is meant to reduce the possibility of accidents between their naval platforms. It is a confidence-building measure intended to prevent misinterpretation of military activities.

Elsewhere, the long-running Falklands dispute between Argentina and the United Kingdom has resurfaced, with disagreements over sovereignty and oil exploration around the islands. The United Kingdom says it has exercised continuous and peaceful authority over the islands, while Argentina considers British control illegitimate and refers to the territory as Las Malvinas. The islands are a British Overseas Territory.

In North America, the United States has moved to rename Lake Ontario as Lake America. Canada opposed the proposal, pointing to the name's Indigenous Wendat origins and its long use. Lake Ontario is one of the five Great Lakes and lies between Ontario province and New York State.

Q1.

Under the 1991 India-Pakistan Agreement on Advance Notice of Military Exercises, what is the minimum distance that naval ships and submarines of the two countries should keep from each other while operating in international waters?

- (A) 3 nautical miles
- (B) 5 nautical miles
- (C) 12 nautical miles
- (D) 1 nautical mile

Q2.

On which date was the 1991 India-Pakistan Agreement on Advance Notice of Military Exercises signed?

- (A) 16 March 1991
- (B) 1 June 1991
- (C) 6 April 1991
- (D) 15 August 1991

Q3.

Assertion (A): The 1991 India-Pakistan agreement aims to reduce the possibility of accidents involving naval platforms of the two countries.

Reason (R): Naval ships and submarines of the two countries are allowed to approach within 3 nautical miles of each other while operating in international waters.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct answer from the options given below.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Falklands Islands	A. Links Lake Ontario with Lake Erie
II. Lake Ontario	B. Establish internationally recognised rules of navigation
III. COLREGs	C. Lie roughly 480 km from Argentina's eastern coast
IV. Welland Canal	D. Smallest of the Great Lakes by surface area

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Lake Ontario:

- I. Lake Ontario is the largest of the five Great Lakes by surface area.
- II. Lake Ontario does not border the state of Michigan.
- III. The Niagara River is the principal source of water entering Lake Ontario.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The COLREGs establish internationally recognised rules of navigation and collision avoidance for vessels at sea.
- II. Argentina became independent from Spain in 1830.
- III. Lake Ontario is the easternmost and final lake in the Great Lakes system.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q7.

In the 2013 referendum held in the Falkland Islands, approximately what percentage of participating islanders voted to retain the islands' status as a British Overseas Territory? (in per cent)

- (A) 99.8
- (B) 96.4
- (C) 88.0
- (D) 51.2

Q8.

As successor to the colonial possessions of which country in the region does Argentina argue that it inherited territorial claims over the Falkland Islands?

- (A) Portugal
- (B) Britain
- (C) France
- (D) Spain

Blue Bonds and the Navier-Stokes Claim

Financial markets are looking beyond conventional projects towards the health of the seas and rivers. A new category of debt instrument is emerging to pay for work that keeps marine and freshwater ecosystems usable and protected over the long term. India plans to join this market through a bond issued by a company that focuses on the maritime sector. The bond will be arranged by a bank's capital markets arm, which has been appointed as arranger. Governments elsewhere have already experimented with similar tools, so the idea is not entirely new.

Science also produced a headline this month. A technology company said that an advanced artificial intelligence model had produced a proposed solution to a long-standing puzzle about how fluids move. Such claims are checked with formal tools that test every step of an argument. The puzzle concerns the equations that describe the motion of water, air and honey, and it belongs to a small group of famous challenges that a mathematics institute has highlighted.

Those equations are not merely theoretical. Engineers rely on them when they design aircraft and automobiles, and scientists use them to predict weather and model currents in the ocean. Progress on the puzzle would therefore matter far beyond mathematics.

Q1.

India's proposed blue bond is best described as a sub-category of which broader instrument?

- (A) Green bonds
- (B) Sovereign bonds
- (C) Municipal bonds
- (D) Infrastructure investment trusts

Q2.

In 2000, the Clay Mathematics Institute designated the Navier-Stokes problem as one of how many Millennium Prize Problems?

- (A) Five
- (B) Six
- (C) Eight
- (D) Seven

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- A. Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited is India's first maritime sector-specific NBFC.
- B. Ocean-current modelling is one of the applications of the fluid equations.
- C. The Navier-Stokes problem was designated a Millennium Prize Problem in 2010.
- D. Seychelles issued the world's first sovereign blue bond in 2019.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q4.

The OpenAI proof claim was reportedly checked using Lean. In the booklet, Lean is described as what?

- (A) A fluid-flow simulation software
- (B) A prize committee for mathematics
- (C) A maritime finance platform
- (D) A computer-based proof assistant

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Navier-Stokes problem:

- I. The fluid equations are based on conservation of mass and Newton's second law of motion.
- II. The Clay Mathematics Institute designated this problem in 2000 as one of seven Millennium Prize Problems.
- III. The fluid equations describe the motion of water and honey, but not air.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q6.

Which country implemented a Debt-for-Ocean Swap in 2021 to support marine conservation?

- (A) Seychelles
- (B) Mauritius
- (C) Belize
- (D) Maldives

Mokha Capture and Red Sea Stakes (MCQ)

Yemen is experiencing a renewed round of fighting, and one recent development has drawn wide attention across the region. The Houthis, an Iran-aligned armed group in Yemen, have captured the strategic port town of Mocha, also written as Mokha, on the Red Sea coast. The capture expands Houthi control along Yemen's western coastline and marks a significant development in the country's conflict.

The event also affects Yemen's civil war more broadly. Strategically, Houthi control of Mocha strengthens the group's position in the area and could increase its leverage over regional maritime traffic. The Houthis emerged as an opposition movement during the 2000s, and they are also part of the Iranian-led Axis of Resistance. They are opposed to Israel and the United States.

The movement's current leader is Abdul-Malik al-Houthi, and the capital, Sanaa, is currently under Houthi control. The government that the Houthis oppose is internationally recognised, and its president is Rashad al-Alimi. The group's control of the port also fits into the wider pattern of Houthi expansion in western Yemen.

The development has implications that go beyond Yemen. Tensions involving Yemen, Saudi Arabia, Iran and other regional powers may intensify, and the events could affect global trade, energy security and Red Sea maritime security.

Q1.

In which Yemeni governorate is the port city of Mokha located?

- (A) Hadramout
- (B) Saada
- (C) Taiz
- (D) Mahra

Q2.

Along with Mokha, the Houthis also seized which two islands?

- (A) Perim and Zuqar
- (B) Hanish and Socotra
- (C) Kamaran and Hanish
- (D) Socotra and Perim

Q3.

After Mokha fell, government forces moved south towards which coastal area?

- (A) Saada
- (B) Fujairah
- (C) Hanish Islands
- (D) Dhubab

Q4.

Examine the two statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Mokha is important mainly for geopolitical and maritime reasons.

Reason (R): Its location enables the Houthis to threaten shipping routes linking the Indian Ocean, Red Sea and Suez Canal.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Hanish Islands	A. Shut by Saudi Arabia after drone strikes from Iraq
II. Bab el-Mandeb Strait	B. Forced some vessels onto longer routes around Africa
III. East-West Oil Pipeline	C. Links the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden
IV. Earlier Houthi attacks on Red Sea shipping	D. Houthi forces advanced towards them in the Red Sea

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Examine the statements given below:

- I. Government forces moved north towards Saada after Mokha fell.
- II. Renewed fighting has caused civilian displacement.
- III. Mokha lies about 80 km from the Bab el-Mandeb Strait.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Mokha capture are correct?

- I. The capture could affect the movement of oil and commodities between Asia and Europe.
- II. The capture reduced Houthi control along Yemen's western coastline.
- III. Government-aligned forces have lost an important coastal position.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Yemen's North-South Divide (MCQ)

Yemen has long been divided between its north and south. The two regions have distinct religious traditions, social structures and systems of governance, and these differences were reinforced by foreign influence and colonial legacies, particularly in the south. The divide is a long-standing feature of Yemen's politics.

The Cold War era also left a lasting mark, because each part of the country was shaped by outside powers during that period. Many of the divisions that exist today can be traced back to the way the two regions developed.

Southern discontent has surfaced repeatedly in the years since. The Southern Movement, known as Al-Hirak, continues to demand greater autonomy or independence for southern Yemen, and the south remains an important part of the country's internal divisions.

A separate council in the south, the Southern Transitional Council, also seeks autonomy or independence. Recent developments show that southern politics is linked with regional powers, which back different groups in the south. Yemen's internal divisions therefore remain relevant to understanding the country today. Yemen's north and south developed separate governance systems, and the booklet links these differences to the country's modern politics. This is why the divide is still discussed in the booklet's account of Yemen's internal divisions.

Q1.

Before the 1990 unification, which power backed South Yemen?

- (A) United States
- (B) Saudi Arabia
- (C) Soviet Union
- (D) Iran

Q2.

In which year did North and South Yemen merge to form the Republic of Yemen?

- (A) 1990
- (B) 1988
- (C) 1994
- (D) 2007

Q3.

In which year did southern leaders attempt secession, leading to a brief civil conflict?

- (A) 1990
- (B) 2007
- (C) 2011
- (D) 1994

Q4.

Examine the two statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Yemen was a single country until 1990.

Reason (R): North Yemen was supported by the United States and Saudi Arabia.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ali Abdullah Saleh	A. Formed in 2007
II. Southern Movement (Al-Hirak)	B. Receives backing from Saudi Arabia
III. Southern Transitional Council	C. Governed North Yemen since 1978
IV. Pro-government military bloc	D. Expanded influence in Hadramout and Mahra

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Examine the statements given below:

- I. The Southern Movement was formed in 1994.
- II. The pro-government military bloc opposes the STC's separatist agenda.
- III. Centralised power after unification created resentment in the south.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the north-south divide are correct?

- I. Ali Abdullah Saleh became President of the unified state.
- II. The UAE backs the Southern Transitional Council.
- III. The Southern Movement was formed in 1990.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Mukalla Strike and UAE Withdrawal (MCQ)

Yemen's south has been at the centre of recent political developments. A council in the south, the Southern Transitional Council, seeks autonomy or independence for southern Yemen and has recently expanded its influence in the Hadramout and Mahra areas. The council receives backing from the UAE.

Opposing the council is a pro-government military bloc. The bloc is closely aligned with the Hadramout tribal alliance, opposes the council's separatist agenda and receives political and strategic backing from Saudi Arabia. The two Gulf countries have therefore supported different sides in the south, and that backing has placed different groups in the south on opposite sides.

Tensions between them became visible in a recent incident at a port in southern Yemen. The UAE rejected the allegation linked to that incident. At the request of the Republic of Yemen, Saudi Arabia had earlier called on the UAE to withdraw its military elements from Yemeni territory within 24 hours and to refrain from providing any military or financial support to any party in the country.

The episode has drawn attention to the wider role of outside powers in Yemen's politics, and to how

the internal divisions of the country are being shaped by the positions of regional states.

Q1.

Saudi Arabia carried out airstrikes on which port in southern Yemen?

- (A) Mokha
- (B) Hodeidah
- (C) Mukalla
- (D) Aden

Q2.

The shipment that reached the port before the strike came from which place?

- (A) Fujairah
- (B) Aden
- (C) Muscat
- (D) Jeddah

Q3.

According to the UAE, what did the shipment consist of?

- (A) Vehicles meant exclusively for UAE forces
- (B) Weapons for separatist groups
- (C) Medical supplies for civilians
- (D) Food aid for the south

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Mukalla Port	A. Port in the UAE where the consignment originated
II. Fujairah	B. Confined to counter-terrorism operations
III. Riyadh's allegation	C. Struck by Saudi airstrikes
IV. UAE military presence in Yemen	D. Alleged arms transfer to separatist groups

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q5.

Examine the statements given below:

- I. The UAE said the consignment carried vehicles meant for its own forces.
- II. The UAE termed Saudi allegations of an arms transfer accurate.
- III. The UAE's military presence in Yemen is confined to counter-terrorism operations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Mukalla incident are correct?

- I. The UAE said Yemen's future should be decided by Yemenis themselves.
 - II. Escalating airstrikes raised risks to UAE personnel in the region.
 - III. The UAE accepted that the vehicles were meant for separatist groups.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Court of Arbitration findings: MCQ

The Court of Arbitration, which sits in The Hague, examined a dispute over the Indus Waters Treaty. The dispute followed India's decision to place the treaty in abeyance after the April 2025 Pahalgam terror attack. The case raised a basic legal question: can one party step away from a treaty because of a security crisis, or must the treaty's own terms and the wider law of treaties decide the matter?

The ruling turned on the text of the treaty. The tribunal looked at the provisions on the Western Rivers, the rivers whose waters are central to the case. It also examined whether the treaty has any rules on terrorism or the use of force, since those issues sat in the background of the dispute.

The ruling also concerned a hydroelectric project on the Chenab. The tribunal placed interim limits on certain work at one of these projects, the Ratle project. Those limits are tied to a later stage of the dispute, which involves a technical expert appointed under the treaty.

India has not accepted the ruling. Its government says the tribunal was constituted improperly and has no authority over its sovereign decisions or its projects on the western rivers. The disagreement therefore covers both the substance of the treaty and the legitimacy of the forum that decided it.

Q1.

Which 1969 convention did the tribunal apply in holding that India's abeyance decision was not permissible?

- (A) Helsinki Rules of 1966
- (B) UN Watercourses Convention of 1997
- (C) Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties
- (D) Geneva Convention of 1949

Q2.

Article III(1) of the Indus Waters Treaty obliges India to let flow the waters of which rivers to Pakistan?

- (A) Eastern Rivers
- (B) Ravi, Beas and Sutlej
- (C) Western Rivers
- (D) All the rivers of the Indus basin

Q3.

What do the tribunal's interim limits on the Ratle project bar?

- (A) All hydropower generation at the project
- (B) Any survey work for future projects
- (C) Any release of water into the Chenab
- (D) Concreting of specified parts of the dam wall and power intake beyond prescribed levels

Q4.

Read the assertion and reason below.

Assertion (A): The tribunal held that India's decision to place the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance was not permissible.

Reason (R): The treaty gives India no unilateral mechanism to suspend its treaty obligations.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article III(1)	A. Interim limits on concreting specified parts of the dam wall
II. Ratle project	B. Not accepted as a material breach by the tribunal
III. Cross-border terrorism	C. Held not permissible under the treaty or international law
IV. Abeyance of the treaty	D. Obliges India to let flow Western Rivers waters to Pakistan

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Read the following statements about the tribunal's ruling:

- I. The tribunal held that the treaty gives India no unilateral mechanism to suspend its obligations.
- II. The tribunal held that the treaty contains provisions on terrorism and the use of force, so cross-border terrorism was a material breach.
- III. The tribunal held that India's abeyance decision was permissible under the Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the ruling are correct?

The tribunal said the treaty continues to apply.

The tribunal found that the abeyance decision was permissible under international law.

The tribunal said the interim limits on the Ratle project last until a set period after the Neutral Expert's final determination.

The tribunal imposed interim limits on the Kishenganga project.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

India's objection to the tribunal: MCQ

The Indus Waters Treaty is an agreement between India and Pakistan on the river system of the Indus basin. Its rules cover how the waters are shared, and it also sets out how disagreements are to be handled. That second part has become the focus of a recent dispute, because India has rejected a ruling from an international tribunal and has questioned whether the tribunal should have been formed at all.

The debate turns on the structure of the treaty. The two countries read its disputes process differently, and the answer affects which forum can hear a particular question. Each reading leads to a different view of whether the tribunal had any role to play. Both sides refer to the same treaty text, and they differ in how they read it. This difference in reading is at the heart of the dispute.

Parallel moves also matter. In the years before the ruling, both sides pursued processes at the same time, and the institutions involved had to decide how those processes could coexist. That history has given the dispute a procedural side, separate from the questions about water.

India's objections therefore concern procedure, legitimacy and the reach of the tribunal, rather than the flow of the rivers themselves.

Q1.

India's Ministry of External Affairs says the Court of Arbitration was constituted by which body, contrary to the treaty?

- (A) United Nations
- (B) International Court of Justice
- (C) International Monetary Fund
- (D) World Bank

Q2.

In India's view of the treaty's dispute route, which step comes immediately after the Permanent Indus Commission?

- (A) Court of Arbitration
- (B) International Court of Justice
- (C) Neutral Expert
- (D) UN Security Council

Q3.

Which Indian ministry rejected the ruling?

- (A) Ministry of External Affairs
- (B) Ministry of Water Resources
- (C) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Defence

Q4.

Read the assertion and reason below.

Assertion (A): India has not taken part in the Court of Arbitration proceedings.

Reason (R): India maintains that the tribunal lacks jurisdiction over its sovereign decisions and infrastructure projects on the western rivers.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pakistan's 2016 proceedings	A. Appointment of a Neutral Expert to examine technical aspects
II. India's 2016 request	B. Remains valid after the April 2025 Pahalgam terror attack, according to New Delhi
III. Ministry of External Affairs	C. Sought establishment of a Court of Arbitration
IV. Abeyance decision	D. Said the tribunal was constituted contrary to the treaty

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Read the following statements about India's position:

- I. India has recognised the legitimacy of the tribunal but has not participated in its proceedings.
- II. In 2016, India requested the appointment of a Neutral Expert to examine technical aspects of the dispute.
- III. According to New Delhi, the abeyance decision after the April 2025 Pahalgam terror attack remains valid.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

India has neither recognised the tribunal's legitimacy nor participated in its proceedings.

According to India's Ministry of External Affairs, the Court of Arbitration was constituted by the United Nations.

In 2016, Pakistan initiated proceedings seeking a Court of Arbitration.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Indus river system: MCQ

The Indus river system is one of the great river systems of South Asia, and its waters are shared by more than one country. The system is made up of a main river and several large tributaries, and each of these rises in a different part of the mountains. Some tributaries begin in high passes and glaciers, while others rise from springs in valleys below.

Because the rivers cross political borders, the way their waters are used is a matter of law as well as geography. Over time, countries and international bodies have developed rules on how shared waters should be managed. These rules cover the use of water in a shared basin and the wider conduct of states that share a watercourse.

The Indus Waters Treaty divides the rivers into two groups, and each group carries different rights for India. The eastern rivers are open to Indian use, while the western rivers are allocated primarily to Pakistan. India keeps some rights over the western rivers, subject to the treaty's conditions.

The booklet describes each river by its sources and by the points where it joins another river. The main tributaries named in the booklet are the Jhelum, the Chenab, the Ravi, the Beas and the Satluj, and each has its own course.

Q1.

The Indus is said to originate at which glacier near Mt Kailash?

- (A) Bokhar Chu Glacier
- (B) Verinag Spring
- (C) Bara Lacha Pass
- (D) Rohtang Pass

Q2.

Read the assertion and reason below.

Assertion (A): The Indus is a trans-boundary river.

Reason (R): The Indus empties into the Arabian Sea near Karachi.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q3.

The Chenab joins which river at Panchnad?

- (A) Satluj
- (B) Beas
- (C) Ravi
- (D) Jhelum

Q4.

How many of the following statements are correct?

The Indus is the longest river in Pakistan.

The Jhelum joins the Chenab at Trimmu.

The Satluj joins the Indus at Panchnad.

The Beas joins the Satluj at Harike.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Consider the following statements about international rules on shared waters:

- I. The Helsinki Rules of 1966 were adopted by the International Law Association.
- II. The Helsinki Convention of 1992 provides a framework for preventing and controlling water pollution across national borders.
- III. India, China and Pakistan have all signed the UN Watercourses Convention of 1997.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Jhelum	A. Originates near Bara Lacha Pass in Lahul-Spiti
II. Ravi	B. Rises from the Manasarovar-Rakas Lakes in Tibet
III. Satluj	C. Rises in the Kullu Hills near Rohtang Pass
IV. Chenab	D. Rises at the Verinag Spring in the Kashmir Valley

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q7.

Which international instrument codified law on the non-navigational uses of international watercourses in 1997?

- (A) Helsinki Rules
- (B) Helsinki Convention
- (C) UN Watercourses Convention
- (D) Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties

Good Friday Agreement and Northern Ireland

The Good Friday, or Belfast, Agreement was a landmark accord for Northern Ireland. It was reached to bring an end to a long period of violence that had divided its people for decades. The agreement set up a system of government in which power would be shared, rather than held by one side alone. It also addressed questions of identity, and it sought to make the border between Northern Ireland and the Republic far less visible. Freedom of movement across the islands was encouraged as part of the settlement. The region's politics has been shaped by the division between those who wish to remain in the UK and those who want a united Ireland.

Its effects have been tested since. When the United Kingdom left the European Union, Northern Ireland found itself with a land border with an EU member state. Checks were then placed between Great Britain and Northern Ireland, and this became a matter of dispute in the region. Political deadlock followed the 2022 election, when a government could not be formed for a time. The UK Government later published a new arrangement to address the problems that had emerged. The Good Friday Agreement remains the reference point for these questions. A border poll is one of the mechanisms the agreement provides for future constitutional change.

Q1.

Under the agreement, who can call a border poll on Irish reunification when conditions show majority support?

- (A) The Prime Minister of Ireland
- (B) The UK Secretary of State for Northern Ireland
- (C) The Scottish First Minister
- (D) The European Commission

Q2.

How many of the following statements about Northern Ireland's arrangements are correct?

- I. The agreement abolished border checks across the UK and Ireland.
- II. Border checks between Great Britain and Northern Ireland were introduced after Brexit.
- III. The DUP leader supported government formation after the May 2022 polls.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q3.

Assertion (A): The DUP leader refused to allow government formation after the May 2022 polls in Northern Ireland.

Reason (R): Unionists were angered by border checks between Great Britain and Northern Ireland.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Under the agreement, people born in Northern Ireland may hold which nationality?

- (A) Irish only
- (B) British only
- (C) Irish or British, or both
- (D) Neither Irish nor British

Q5.

Statements about the Good Friday Agreement:

- I. Reunification with Ireland can be sought only through a vote in the UK Parliament, not a referendum.
- II. Northern Ireland's government is formed on the wishes of both Republicans and Unionists.
- III. Safeguarding the Union was passed as an Act of the Irish parliament.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) II only
- (D) II and III only

Q6.

Under the agreement, the Northern Ireland government would be formed on the wishes of whom?

- (A) Unionists only
- (B) The UK Parliament
- (C) The European Union
- (D) Republicans and Unionists

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. The Troubles	A. Citizens may hold either or both
II. Safeguarding the Union	B. Can be called by the UK Secretary of State for Northern Ireland
III. Border poll	C. Conflict ended by the Good Friday Agreement
IV. Irish or British nationality	D. Command paper setting out a new deal after the 2022 deadlock

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Sanctioning Russia Act: Scope and Review

The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 is a law that the United States has enacted. The measure followed Senate approval and House passage, and it was then signed by the President. Its main aim is to increase economic pressure on Russia, and it also extends and strengthens certain sanctions against Iran. The Act targets political, financial, energy and commercial networks linked to Russia's war in Ukraine. It is now federal law with greater legal permanence.

The Act's criteria bring major buyers of Russian oil and gas within its scope. India is one such buyer because it remains one of the major buyers of Russian crude. Tariffs under the Act can fall on the largest purchasers of Russian energy and on facilitators of Russian oil sanctions evasion. Certain goods of Russian origin may also face tariffs, subject to specified exceptions.

The list of relevant purchasers is not fixed. It is reviewed periodically, in consultation with other senior officials. Countries that import only a small share of their natural gas from Russia can qualify for an exception if they take significant steps to reduce such imports. The sanctions framework may also be affected if certain conditions relating to the war are met.

Q1.

Under the Act, which of the following conditions could affect the sanctions framework?

- (A) Russia expands its energy exports to Asia
- (B) Russia ceases military hostilities
- (C) Russia increases its defence budget
- (D) Russia joins the World Trade Organization

Q2.

Which body must review the list of major Russian oil and gas importers?

- (A) US Trade Representative (USTR)
- (B) UN Security Council
- (C) NATO Secretariat
- (D) Reserve Bank of India

Q3.

What review cycle does the Act provide for reassessing relevant purchasers?

- (A) 30-day
- (B) 90-day
- (C) 180-day
- (D) 365-day

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Iran Sanctions Act extension (year)	A. 500%
II. Natural gas import share for exception	B. 2031
III. Tariff on Russian-origin goods (maximum)	C. 5
IV. Largest purchasers facing tariffs (number)	D. 15%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the statements below about the sanctions framework:

- I. The President signed the Act into law on 18 September 2026.
- II. The Act names India directly as a country subject to its tariffs.
- III. Russia ending activities aimed at undermining the Ukrainian Government is one condition for ending the framework.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Read the statements below about the Act.

- I. The House of Representatives passed the legislation by 262 votes to 159.
- II. The Act sets a 30-day review cycle for relevant purchasers.
- III. The Act authorises tariffs of up to 100% on the largest purchasers of Russian oil and gas.

How many of these statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Sanctions Act: India and Global Oil

The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 was enacted by the United States in September 2026. The Act is aimed mainly at economic pressure on Russia over the war in Ukraine, and it also strengthens certain sanctions against Iran. Its criteria place major buyers of Russian energy within its scope. The measure was passed by Congress and signed into federal law, which gives it greater legal permanence. It follows an earlier punitive tariff on India for buying Russian oil. The authorisation covers tariffs on major purchasers of Russian oil and natural gas.

India remains one of the major buyers of Russian crude, so the measure matters for India's energy

planning. Russia is a major source of India's oil, and the country depends on imports to meet a large part of its energy demand. This makes the measure significant for India.

The measure reflects a broader pattern in which tariffs and sanctions are used to shape the conduct of other countries. Crude oil is traded in a connected global market.

Russia's war in Ukraine remains the central context for the measure. Indian policymakers face a difficult set of choices. They must weigh their relationships with the United States, Russia and other major powers while protecting national energy interests.

Q1.

According to the booklet, what could major buyers do before potential tariff measures take effect?

- (A) Stop all purchases of Russian crude
- (B) Increase purchases before potential tariff measures
- (C) Shift all shipments to a single supplier
- (D) Cancel every energy contract

Q2.

Removing substantial Russian crude from global markets could place additional pressure on what, if alternative supplies are insufficient?

- (A) Gold prices in global markets
- (B) Shipping insurance rates in Europe
- (C) Government bond yields in India
- (D) International oil prices

Q3.

Discounted crude improves buyers' economics, but replacing large volumes of it is challenging in which respect?

- (A) Logistical
- (B) Constitutional
- (C) Demographic
- (D) Cultural

Q4.

Assertion (A): Higher import bills can raise the cost of transport and manufacturing.

Reason (R): Higher import bills drive up transport, logistics, manufacturing and consumer prices.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Discounted crude	A. Complicates India-U.S. bilateral trade
II. Replacing large volumes of crude	B. Improves buyers' economics
III. Potential tariffs	C. Reconfigured by major buyers
IV. Energy contracts of major buyers	D. Logistically challenging

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the statements below about how major buyers may respond:

- I. Buyers may develop alternative payment and logistics arrangements.
- II. Replacing large volumes of discounted crude is logistically easy.
- III. Buyers may reconfigure energy contracts.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Read the statements below and choose the option giving the number of correct statements.

- I. Discounted crude improves the economics for buyers.
- II. Replacing large volumes of Russian crude is logistically easy.
- III. Major buyers may diversify their suppliers.

How many of these statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Sino-Indian Border: States, UTs and Sectors

India and China share a long frontier that runs along the Himalayan range. Much of this frontier is not a settled international boundary, and the working line between the two sides is called the Line of Actual Control. It is described as an effective military border that separates Indian-controlled areas from those held by China. Officials describe the LAC as a practical boundary rather than a legally recognised one. The frontier passes through several Indian states and one Union Territory, and each stretch has its own terrain and local conditions. India administers Arunachal Pradesh as a full-fledged state with established government institutions and civil administration. For management purposes, the LAC is divided into sectors so that officials can focus on a defined stretch. In 1954, India and China signed the Panchsheel Agreement, and its principles included a pledge by both sides to respect each other's sovereignty and territorial integrity. The slogan Hindi-Chini Bhai Bhai captured the mood of mutual trust at that time. The LAC took its practical shape after the 1962 Sino-Indian War, when a ceasefire left each side in control of different areas. Since then, both countries have used a range of mechanisms to manage incidents along the line while the wider question remains open.

Q1.

Which Union Territory shares a border with China?

- (A) Puducherry
- (B) Lakshadweep
- (C) Ladakh
- (D) Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Q2.

Sikkim borders China along with which two other countries?

- (A) Nepal and Bhutan
- (B) Nepal and Myanmar
- (C) Bhutan and Bangladesh
- (D) Myanmar and Bhutan

Q3.

Which of these states borders China and forms part of the Middle Sector of the LAC?

- (A) Sikkim
- (B) Himachal Pradesh
- (C) Haryana
- (D) Punjab

Q4.

Assertion (A): Ladakh shares the longest border segment with China among all Indian states and UTs.

Reason (R): Ladakh borders Xinjiang Province of China.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements about India's border with China:

- I. The border runs through one Union Territory and four states.
- II. Arunachal Pradesh shares the longest border segment with China.
- III. The Panchsheel Agreement was signed by Nehru and Zhou Enlai.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Arunachal Pradesh borders Myanmar.
- II. Uttarakhand borders China and Nepal.
- III. Himachal Pradesh forms part of the Eastern Sector.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

What name does China use for the part of Arunachal Pradesh that it claims?

- (A) Southern Xinjiang
- (B) Greater Hotan
- (C) Lower Ladakh
- (D) South Tibet

Border Management Mechanisms and Agreements

India and China have not reached a final settlement of their boundary dispute, which covers a frontier of 3,488 km along the Himalayan range. Instead, the two sides manage the Line of Actual Control through a layered set of meetings and agreements. Those meetings take place at several levels, from senior government representatives to local officers who work along the line. Military officers also take part in talks when tensions rise, and their discussions are aimed at calming the situation on the ground. Several agreements were signed from the 1990s onward, adding further rules to the arrangement. A later agreement aimed to strengthen communication between the border forces of the two countries. The arrangement has grown over several decades, and each step has added a channel or a rule rather than settling the question. The frontier is also divided into sectors for management purposes, so that each stretch can be discussed separately. The line

itself is a practical boundary rather than a legally recognised international border, so these arrangements matter for daily management. Because the frontier is long and varied, managing it is a continuing task. Together, these tools help keep the frontier calm while the wider dispute remains open.

Q1.

Which mechanism is the highest political-level channel for pursuing a final political settlement of the boundary dispute?

- (A) Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination
- (B) Corps Commander-level Meetings
- (C) Special Representatives on Boundary Question
- (D) Border Personnel Meeting Points

Q2.

Which mechanism, set up in 2012, is a diplomatic and military channel for LAC incidents and has no mandate to settle the boundary?

- (A) Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination
- (B) Special Representatives on Boundary Question
- (C) Border Personnel Meeting Points
- (D) Corps Commander-level Meetings

Q3.

Which agreement restricted military activities and the use of weapons near the LAC?

- (A) 1993 Agreement for Maintenance of Peace and Tranquillity along the LAC
- (B) 1996 Confidence-Building Measures Agreement
- (C) 2005 CBM Protocol
- (D) 2013 Border Defence Cooperation Agreement

Q4.

Which mechanism pursues tactical disengagement, de-escalation and buffer-zone arrangements during major standoffs?

- (A) Border Personnel Meeting Points
- (B) Special Representatives on Boundary Question
- (C) Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination
- (D) Corps Commander-level Meetings

Q5.

Assertion (A): The Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination has the mandate to settle the boundary dispute.

Reason (R): The Working Mechanism coordinates diplomatic and military responses to LAC incidents.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The 1993 agreement recognised the LAC and committed both sides to maintaining peace.
- II. The 2005 CBM Protocol set procedures for face-to-face encounters between troops.
- III. The Special Representatives mechanism was set up in 1993.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Border Personnel Meeting Points are designated locations where local military commanders address ground-level friction.
 - II. The 1996 Confidence-Building Measures agreement was signed during Chinese President Jiang Zemin's visit to India.
 - III. The Working Mechanism was set up in 2003.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Mercator Projection: Shape, Size and Grid

Turning the round surface of the Earth into a flat map always involves some distortion. Different projections handle this in different ways, and the Mercator design is one of the most familiar. On the Mercator grid, longitudes are evenly spaced, but the gaps between latitudes widen as one moves towards the Poles. This spacing is a deliberate feature of the design, and it keeps the shapes of landmasses locally recognisable. The trade-off is that landmasses far from the Equator appear much larger than they really are, so the amount of exaggeration depends on how far a landmass lies from the Equator. Africa, for example, looks similar in size to Greenland on such a map, even though the two differ greatly in reality. Antarctica is also drawn far larger than its true size. On a standard wall map, India looks like a middleweight beside Scandinavia, which shows how much the grid can change the impression of a country's size. The Equal Earth projection is a newer design, used for thematic maps, that aims to show the whole globe in a more balanced way. Choosing a projection depends on what a map is meant to show, and each design makes its own choices about which features to keep.

Q1.

What was the Mercator projection primarily designed to assist?

- (A) Comparing the sizes of continents
- (B) Maritime navigation
- (C) Thematic mapping
- (D) School atlases

Q2.

On a Mercator grid, rhumb lines appear as:

- (A) Curves
- (B) Circles
- (C) Straight lines
- (D) Zigzag lines

Q3.

In reality, Greenland is roughly the size of which country?

- (A) Democratic Republic of Congo
- (B) Mexico
- (C) Kazakhstan
- (D) Saudi Arabia

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Mercator projection preserves the relative area of landmasses.

Reason (R): The stretching of parallels is matched exactly with the stretching of meridians on the Mercator grid.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Which projection type does the Mercator projection belong to?

- (A) Equal-area and pseudo-cylindrical
- (B) Cylindrical and conformal
- (C) Equidistant and conical
- (D) Compromise and azimuthal

Q6.

Read the following statements about the Mercator projection:

- I. The Mercator projection preserves the relative area of landmasses.
- II. Gerardus Mercator was a Flemish geographer and cartographer.
- III. Antarctica appears smaller than its true size on the Mercator grid.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about map projections are correct?

- I. The Mercator projection has been widely used for centuries.
- II. The Mercator projection is an equal-area projection.
- III. The Equal Earth projection was designed to display the entire surface of the globe.
- IV. The Mercator projection is a compromise projection that balances area, shape, distance and direction.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Other Projections and Mapping in India

Map projections are not a single fixed method, and cartographers have produced many of them over time. Every flat map is a trade-off, because a flat sheet cannot match the curved surface of the globe in every respect. The Winkel Tripel was designed to reduce distortion across area, distance and direction together, instead of perfecting one property at the cost of the others. It belongs to a wider group of compromise designs, which spread errors across several properties rather than concentrating them in one. Major institutions, including a large geographic society and the World Bank, later adopted it for their maps. Such compromise maps are used for general reference and world maps, where a natural-looking view of the whole globe is useful. Choosing a projection depends on the purpose of the map, so a design that suits one task may be poor for another. Accuracy matters in official mapping for a different reason. The Survey of India is a national body that works on official maps, and among its tasks is establishing geodetic reference frameworks, which give surveys a common base. The same survey body also checks how international borders appear on published maps. Maps published in India are also subject to legal rules that control how borders may be shown.

Q1.

The Gall-Peters projection was popularised by Arno Peters in which year?

- (A) 1921
- (B) 1963
- (C) 1973
- (D) 2018

Q2.

Which projection is a compromise projection with meridians curving gently towards the Poles?

- (A) Robinson
- (B) Gall-Peters
- (C) Mercator
- (D) Equal Earth

Q3.

Assertion (A): The Robinson projection preserves area exactly.

Reason (R): The Robinson projection was devised by Arthur H. Robinson to balance size and shape.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Read the following statements:

- I. The Gall-Peters projection preserves area accurately but makes landmasses look stretched or squashed.
- II. The Winkel Tripel projection was created in 1963.
- III. The Criminal Law Amendment Act (1961) penalises maps that misrepresent India's borders.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Gall-Peters projection	A. Established in 1767
II. Robinson projection	B. Oswald Winkel
III. Winkel Tripel projection	C. Arthur H. Robinson
IV. Survey of India	D. James Gall

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Survey of India are correct?

- I. The Survey of India is headed by the Surveyor General of India.
- II. John Mather undertook a modern scientific survey of India.
- III. The Survey of India is headed by a Director General.
- IV. The Survey of India is headquartered in Bengaluru.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Which ministry acts as the nodal agency for the Survey of India?

- (A) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (B) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- (C) Ministry of Science and Technology
- (D) Ministry of External Affairs

Status and Powers of the Election Commission

The Election Commission of India is a permanent, all-India and independent body that conducts elections across the country. Its basic task is to ensure that elections to the Lok Sabha, the Rajya Sabha and the State Legislative Assemblies are free and fair, and it also oversees the elections of the President and the Vice President. Since 1993, the Commission has been a three-member body. It consists of one Chief Election Commissioner and two Election Commissioners, who together carry out its work. The Commission shares responsibility for electoral rolls with the state chief electoral officers and state election commissions. An electoral roll is the official list of people eligible to vote in a given election within a specific area, and being on that list is a legal requirement for casting a vote. Its work involves preparing voter lists and managing polls, and it also has functions that the Constitution and the courts have helped to define. Because its powers are rooted in the Constitution, the Commission is described as a constitutional body. Its members also enjoy fixed service conditions that cannot be varied to their disadvantage after appointment.

Q1.

Under which power does the ECI resolve disputes over party recognition and allocate election symbols?

- (A) Administrative power
- (B) Advisory power
- (C) Quasi-judicial power
- (D) Legislative power

Q2.

In which situation can the ECI order a re-poll?

- (A) Only when a court disqualifies a candidate
- (B) When a State Legislature amends the election law
- (C) When voter turnout falls below half the electorate
- (D) When the purity of the electoral process is compromised

Q3.

When does judicial review of the ECI's decisions usually take place?

- (A) Before the poll schedule is announced
- (B) After the election process
- (C) Immediately after nominations are filed
- (D) Only during a national emergency

Q4.

Read the statements below.

Assertion (A): The ECI can act independently to safeguard free and fair elections where laws made by Parliament or State Legislatures are silent.

Reason (R): The scope of the ECI's powers under Articles 327 and 328 covers situations in which such laws are silent.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the ECI:

- I. The advisory power of the ECI includes guiding the authorities during emergencies.
- II. Judicial review of the ECI's actions generally takes place before the election process begins.
- III. The principles of natural justice are applied in a flexible and pragmatic manner in electoral matters.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the ECI:

- I. The administrative power of the ECI covers scheduling elections.
- II. The advisory power of the ECI covers resolving disputes over party recognition.
- III. The advisory power of the ECI covers advising the President and Governors.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

The Election Commission of India is a constitutional body under which Part of the Constitution?

- (A) Part III
- (B) Part XVII
- (C) Part XX
- (D) Part XV

The EVM and the VVPAT

The Electronic Voting Machine, known as the EVM, is an electronic device that records votes in place of the traditional ballot papers and ballot boxes. The machine has been used in elections to the Lok Sabha, State Legislative Assemblies and by-elections, and it has been in use across different parts of the country for several decades. Since it is electronic, votes are stored in the machine rather than being collected and counted manually from paper. A companion system, the Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail, is attached to the EVM and is meant to give voters a way to check their choice. The system is described as an independent unit that works alongside the EVM. The purpose of this arrangement is to increase confidence in the voting process among voters and political parties alike. Courts have also commented on the role of such systems in elections, and several judgments have discussed them. The overall aim is to make the physical record of each vote

available for verification. Its use expanded gradually over the following years, and it was extended to elections across the country.

Q1.

Which Assembly constituency first used EVMs in 1982?

- (A) Noksen, Nagaland
- (B) Paravur, Kerala
- (C) Bangalore, Karnataka
- (D) Hyderabad, Telangana

Q2.

For how many seconds does the VVPAT slip remain visible through the transparent window?

- (A) 3 seconds
- (B) 5 seconds
- (C) 10 seconds
- (D) 7 seconds

Q3.

Along with Electronic Corporation of India Ltd, which company developed the EVM?

- (A) Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd
- (B) Bharat Electronics Ltd
- (C) Indian Telephone Industries Ltd
- (D) Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Control Unit	A. Seven seconds
II. Balloting Unit	B. First VVPAT use (2013)
III. VVPAT slip visibility	C. Kept with the Polling Officer
IV. Noksen Assembly bye-election	D. Placed in the voting booth

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the EVM and VVPAT:

- I. The VVPAT machines can be accessed by Polling Officers only.
- II. The Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961 were amended to allow a printer with a drop box to be attached to the EVM.
- III. The EVM was first used in Kerala in 1989.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the EVM and VVPAT:

- I. The EVM records votes in place of ballot papers and boxes.
- II. The VVPAT slip remains visible for 10 seconds before it falls into the drop box.
- III. EVMs were adopted for general elections in 2004.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Why Semiconductors Matter: MCQ

Semiconductors are fundamental to modern technological systems, and they are built into a wide range of products. Automobiles and healthcare equipment are two of the many areas that depend on them, and consumer electronics relies on them as well. Because so much of modern life depends on these components, their availability shapes how resilient digital and industrial supply chains can be. Chip design has advanced to the point where a single chip can hold billions of transistors packed into an extremely small area. The most advanced processors use very fine manufacturing technology and can integrate a very large number of transistors. Such capability supports demanding workloads and advanced digital applications. The electronics industry that these chips serve is very large, and semiconductors form part of its base in modern technology. The way production is organised has also been questioned. Past disruptions showed how much risk comes from relying on a small number of places for supply. In response, many governments have looked for ways to build their own chip-making strength and to draw components from a wider set of sources.

Q1.

According to the booklet, which of the following sectors is one where semiconductors are widely used?

- (A) Textiles
- (B) Mining
- (C) Shipping
- (D) Aerospace

Q2.

According to the booklet, the global electronics industry is valued at approximately how many trillion US dollars?

- (A) 1.5
- (B) 2.8
- (C) 4.3
- (D) 6.0

Q3.

Which pair of materials is given in the booklet as examples of semiconductors?

- (A) Silicon and germanium
- (B) Copper and iron
- (C) Gold and silver
- (D) Aluminium and carbon

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Leading-edge 3-nanometre processors	A. Vulnerabilities from concentrated supply chains
II. Global electronics industry	B. Materials with conductivity between conductors and insulators
III. Silicon and germanium	C. Tens of billions of transistors
IV. COVID-19 pandemic	D. Approximately USD 4.3 trillion

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Semiconductors are used in automobiles, healthcare, defence, aerospace, telecommunications and consumer electronics.
- II. Modern chips can contain billions of transistors within extremely small areas.
- III. Materials with conductivity greater than conductors are called semiconductors.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Modern chips can contain billions of transistors within extremely small areas.
 - II. COVID-19 exposed vulnerabilities arising from dispersion of global semiconductor supply chains.
 - III. Leading-edge processors based on 3-nanometre technology can integrate tens of billions of transistors.
- (A) Only three
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) All of the above

SEMICON India and the Programme: MCQ

SEMICON India is a conference and exhibition that showcases India's semiconductor capabilities. It gives the sector one place to display its progress, and each edition is an occasion to present the work done in chip-related fields. The event is staged alongside the national effort to build a domestic base for chips, which the government has pursued through a dedicated programme. Its organisation involves the India Semiconductor Mission, which serves as the nodal body for the schemes in this area. The gathering brings together displays of work from across the sector, which makes it a useful window into the country's chip-related strengths.

The Semicon India Programme is the central scheme behind this effort. Its objective is to establish a complete set of capabilities in the country, running from the creation of designs through to the production and packaging of chips. The programme's work is grouped into several connected areas, and it also covers the training of skilled people and the support of research and new ideas.

Several projects have already been announced, with companies planning facilities in different parts

of the country. Some of these projects involve partnerships between Indian companies and overseas firms, and they show how the programme's goals are being turned into physical units. The projects are spread across several states and cover different stages of chip making.

Q1.

Who inaugurated SEMICON India 2026?

- (A) President Droupadi Murmu
- (B) Union IT Minister
- (C) PM Modi
- (D) Chief Minister of Gujarat

Q2.

Where was the first edition of SEMICON India held in 2022?

- (A) New Delhi
- (B) Hyderabad
- (C) Gandhinagar
- (D) Bengaluru

Q3.

In which year was the Semicon India Programme launched?

- (A) 2021
- (B) 2019
- (C) 2020
- (D) 2022

Q4.

Consider the following two statements.

Assertion (A): SEMICON India is an annual flagship conference and exhibition that showcases India's semiconductor capabilities.

Reason (R): SEMICON India is organised by the India Semiconductor Mission, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology and SEMI.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Theme of SEMICON India 2026	A. SEMI
II. Venue of the 2026 inauguration	B. 2021
III. Launch year of the Semicon India Programme	C. Yashobhoomi, New Delhi
IV. Co-organiser alongside the India Semiconductor Mission and MeitY	D. Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Semicon India Programme was launched in 2021 to establish a complete semiconductor ecosystem in India.
- II. The first edition of SEMICON India was held in Bengaluru in 2022.
- III. PM Modi inaugurated SEMICON India 2026 at Dholera (Gujarat).

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Chip design and fabrication are among the focus areas of the Semicon India Programme.
- II. SEMICON India is organised by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
- III. Advanced packaging is among the focus areas of the Semicon India Programme.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Why the MDR framework was introduced

Unified Payments Interface (UPI) has grown into a large digital payment infrastructure that handles billions of transactions every month. As the network expands, it serves more users and more transactions, and its server capacity and customer support must keep pace. To meet these needs, the National Payments Corporation of India introduced a Merchant Discount Rate framework for certain UPI transactions. The framework gives the payment ecosystem a revenue mechanism of its own. The zero-MDR policy, introduced in 2020, had exempted merchants from paying any fee for UPI and RuPay transactions to encourage digital adoption, particularly among small traders and informal sectors. The new framework is designed so that everyday low-value transactions remain free, and the government and the payments body have both emphasised protecting small merchants and ordinary users from additional costs. Essential services such as railways, telecom, insurance and fuel are treated separately under the framework. Capital markets also receive a separate treatment. The booklet presents the framework against this background of network growth, and readers should look at its reasons as well as its rates to understand why it was introduced.

Q1.

Under the 'Innovation' reason for the framework, what can its revenue support?

- (A) Cash withdrawals at ATMs
- (B) Payments to foreign central banks
- (C) Technological improvements and new payment solutions
- (D) Mandatory bank account opening

Q2.

Which reason for the framework is linked to eligible small merchants continuing to receive zero-MDR benefits?

- (A) Support for Small Businesses
- (B) Financial Sustainability
- (C) Cybersecurity
- (D) Infrastructure Development

Q3.

Assertion (A): The framework was introduced partly to reduce UPI's dependence on continued public funding.

Reason (R): A payment ecosystem with its own revenue mechanism can reduce dependence on continued public funding.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Financial Sustainability	A. Eligible small merchants keep zero-MDR benefits
II. Cybersecurity	B. Revenue supports continued operation and expansion
III. Innovation	C. Stronger systems for preventing fraud and cyber threats
IV. Support for Small Businesses	D. Revenue supports technological improvements and new payment solutions

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the reasons for the MDR framework:

- I. UPI requires continuous investment in payment infrastructure and technology.
- II. MDR revenue is a tax collected by the government.
- III. Revenue can support technological improvements and new payment solutions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the MDR framework are correct?

- I. Infrastructure development is one of the stated reasons for the framework.
- II. MDR revenue is distributed only to the NPCI.
- III. Consumer protection is one of the stated reasons for the framework.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only three

Q7.

Which of the following is NOT listed among the stated reasons for the framework?

- (A) Cybersecurity
- (B) Innovation
- (C) Infrastructure Development
- (D) Public-sector advertising

MDR, UPI and NPCI basics

The network has grown into a major platform that handles a very large number of transactions every month, and its services are meant for both small and large users. Many everyday low-value transactions take place on it. Behind the system is an organisation that operates and develops retail payment and settlement systems in India. Digital payments have expanded over the years, and the booklet links this growth to the need for continued investment. Keeping such a network working smoothly is a continuing task, and the booklet describes several areas that need attention as it grows. The framework discussed in the booklet applies to merchant payments above a certain value and treats some sectors separately. Readers who want to understand it should look at its slabs, its exemptions and the reasons behind it.

Q1.

Among which participants is the MDR distributed, according to the booklet?

- (A) Only the NPCI
- (B) Banks, payment service providers and other relevant participants
- (C) Only customers
- (D) State governments

Q2.

Which of the following is a stated feature of UPI?

- (A) Available only during bank working hours
- (B) Real-time, 24/7, instant and interoperable transactions
- (C) Limited to transactions within one bank
- (D) Paper-based clearing

Q3.

Which of the following countries is NOT listed in the booklet as accepting UPI?

- (A) Nepal
- (B) Qatar
- (C) Mauritius
- (D) Italy

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. MDR	A. Real-time, 24/7 interoperable payment system
II. UPI	B. Remains within the payment ecosystem
III. NPCI	C. Fee for processing a digital payment, borne by the merchant
IV. MDR revenue	D. Umbrella organisation for retail payment and settlement systems

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the payment system in the booklet:

- I. MDR is a tax collected by the government.
- II. Sri Lanka is among the countries that accept UPI.
- III. Qatar is among the countries that accept UPI.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. MDR is a fee charged for processing a digital payment transaction.
- II. UPI was developed by the Reserve Bank of India.
- III. Mauritius is a country listed among those accepting UPI.

- (A) Only one
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only two
- (D) Only three

BRICS 2026 Summit Overview

India hosted the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi in 2026, a year in which the country held the grouping's chairship for the fourth time. The chairship ran under the theme 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.' The 2026 calendar also included several ministerial and sectoral meetings held in different Indian cities. The meetings covered urbanisation, energy, transport, friendship between cities and the work of chief justices. The programme of meetings ran across several months of the year, with dates spread from June to September 2026. The host cities listed for these meetings span more than one Indian state. Each meeting formed part of India's role as chair, which covered financial, scientific, health and security cooperation among member countries. The outcomes were grouped under several headings. These included financial, economic and trade cooperation, taxation and customs cooperation, agriculture and food security, health and medicine, transport, logistics and climate cooperation, security, law and social cooperation, culinary diplomacy, and geopolitical mandates with global governance. India also showcased regional products during the summit itself, as part of its culinary diplomacy. The year also marked 25 years since the BRIC concept first emerged. Earlier Indian chairships had taken place on several occasions before 2026.

Q1.

At which venue was the 18th BRICS Leaders' Summit held in New Delhi?

- (A) Pragati Maidan
- (B) Vigyan Bhawan
- (C) Rashtrapati Bhavan
- (D) Bharat Mandapam

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Resilience	A. Environmentally sustainable and inclusive economic growth
II. Innovation	B. Collaboration among BRICS countries in different sectors
III. Cooperation	C. New technologies, research and digital solutions for development
IV. Sustainability	D. Dealing with economic, environmental and geopolitical challenges

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q3.

Consider the following statements about the 2026 meetings:

- I. The BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting was held in Gurugram, Haryana.
- II. The BRICS Friendship Cities Conclave was held in Nagpur, Maharashtra.
- III. The BRICS Transport Ministers' Meeting was the third of its kind.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The BRICS Urbanisation Forum was the 13th of its kind.
- II. The BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting was the 12th of its kind.
- III. The BRICS Transport Ministers' Meeting was the 3rd of its kind.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Which 2026 BRICS meeting was held in Nagpur?

- (A) BRICS Urbanisation Forum
- (B) BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting
- (C) BRICS Chief Justices' Forum
- (D) BRICS Transport Ministers' Meeting

Q6.

Gucchi Marmik, the showcase used by India at the summit, featured which regional product?

- (A) Himalayan Gucci mushrooms
- (B) Alphonso mangoes
- (C) Darjeeling tea
- (D) Kashmiri saffron

Science and Digital Outcomes

The 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi carried a set of outcomes in science, technology and digital infrastructure. These outcomes covered satellites, digital public infrastructure, scientific collaboration, smart grids and entrepreneurship. Cooperation under the BRICS Remote Sensing Satellite Constellation was expanded at the summit. The chairship's theme included innovation, which the summit described as promoting new technologies, research and digital solutions for development. The theme also named resilience, which was described as strengthening countries' ability to deal with economic, environmental and geopolitical challenges. Among the named initiatives were a Digital Centre of Excellence for Smart Grids and a BRICS Incubator Network. Other items covered a network called GRAIN and the grouping's work on satellites. Both appeared within the science section of the outcomes. The key outcomes were grouped under several headings. These included financial, economic and trade cooperation, taxation and customs cooperation, agriculture and food security, health and medicine, transport, logistics and climate cooperation, security, law and social cooperation, culinary diplomacy, and geopolitical mandates with global governance. Science and technology items formed just one part of the wider summit agenda.

Q1.

Pilot projects were initiated at the summit for sharing which type of goods?

- (A) Open-source digital public goods
- (B) Pharmaceutical generics
- (C) Agricultural seeds
- (D) Industrial patents

Q2.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The proposed BRICS Space Council has been formally set up as an operating body.
- II. Collective satellite data is intended to support climate monitoring.
- III. The BRICS DPI Repository was approved for creation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q3.

Terms were drafted for a proposed BRICS council in which area?

- (A) Trade
- (B) Health
- (C) Climate
- (D) Space

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Digital Centre of Excellence for Smart Grids was established at the summit.
- II. The BRICS Incubator Network was launched at the summit.
- III. GRAIN is a grain trading exchange set up by the summit.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Collective satellite data	A. Entrepreneurship and innovation-led growth
II. GRAIN	B. Disaster risk reduction and climate monitoring
III. BRICS Incubator Network	C. AI-enabled integration of renewable energy
IV. Digital Centre of Excellence for Smart Grids	D. Pooling financial and intellectual resources for high-cost megascience projects

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q6.

GRAIN, for which an action plan was adopted at the summit, stands for which of the following?

- (A) Grain Resource and Inventory Network
- (B) General Research and Innovation Network
- (C) Global Research Advanced Infrastructure Network
- (D) Global Resource for Agricultural Information Network

Security and Global Governance

Security, law and social cooperation formed one of the main groups of outcomes at the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi. Under the counter-terrorism heading, the summit condemned cross-border terrorism, and the outcomes contained further items on corruption. Labour, social security and culture formed another heading, and the outcomes welcomed a cooperation network for capacity building, employability and new skills. Global governance was a further heading, covering reform of international institutions and proposals on how the international system should operate. India's framework seeks to move the international system towards a more inclusive model of global partnership. The outcomes also included a culinary diplomacy heading, under which India showcased regional products during the summit. India was chairing BRICS for the fourth time in 2026, and the chairship ran under the theme 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.' Overall, the outcomes were grouped under headings that covered security, science, finance, health and culture. The security heading sat near the end of the outcomes, after the science and health sections. The summit concluded with the New Delhi Declaration, which the outcomes described as emphasising multilateralism. The chairship also featured a series of ministerial and sectoral meetings across several Indian cities. The outcomes ended with a note on the next chairship.

Q1.

Which country was confirmed as host of the 19th BRICS Summit in 2027?

- (A) Russia
- (B) Brazil
- (C) China
- (D) South Africa

Q2.

The summit's condemnation of cross-border terrorism also referred to which 2025 event?

- (A) A 2025 cross-border trade dispute
- (B) The 2025 Pahalgam terror attack
- (C) A 2025 maritime border incident
- (D) A 2025 cyber attack on member states

Q3.

Assertion (A): BRICS adopted the UN Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism at the summit.

Reason (R): BRICS urged progress towards the UN Comprehensive Convention on International Terrorism.

In the light of the above statements, choose the correct answer.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- (C) A is true but R is false.
- (D) A is false but R is true.

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ezulwini Consensus and Sirte Declaration	A. Gig workers' rights and cross-border portability of social security
II. BRICS CONNECT	B. Representation, Responsiveness, Rule-making
III. India's 3R Framework	C. Expanded representation on the ICAO Council
IV. Ethiopia and Indonesia	D. Greater African representation in a reformed UN Security Council

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. BRICS endorsed the WTO accession bids of Ethiopia and Iran.
- II. China and Russia expressed support for India's and Brazil's aspirations for greater representation.
- III. The 19th BRICS Summit is to be hosted by Russia.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. An expert network for tracing fugitive offenders has been established.
- II. BRICS CONNECT is aimed at strengthening the rights of farmers.
- III. The summit endorsed the Ezulwini Consensus.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

The expert network for tracing fugitive offenders aims to facilitate recovery of what?

- (A) Illegally acquired national assets
- (B) Unpaid trade invoices
- (C) Gig workers' wages
- (D) Illegal mining licences

SCO membership and bodies

The SCO brings together a group of countries that sit at the crossroads of Central Asia, South Asia and East Asia. Russia and Iran also take part in its work, which gives the grouping a wide geographical reach. The organisation runs cooperation programmes in several areas, including security, trade, transport and cultural contacts. Its work is spread across a set of bodies, and each body handles a separate part of the agenda. The organisation's leaders meet every year, and the host country for that meeting rotates along with the chairmanship. The organisation marked its 25th anniversary in 2026, and its theme for that year stressed sustainable peace, development and prosperity. Over time, the membership has expanded in stages, and the organisation has brought in new partners as its reach has grown. The SCO also encourages political dialogue among its members and supports exchanges between the peoples of the region. Together, these features show a grouping that combines security concerns with economic and cultural work across a large part of the continent. Its members include several large states, and its meetings give them a regular channel for discussion at the highest political level. One of its stated objectives is to strengthen mutual trust, good-neighbourliness and mutual support on issues of security.

Q1.

In which year did India and Pakistan become full members of the SCO?

- (A) 2005
- (B) 2023
- (C) 2017
- (D) 2024

Q2.

The Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) of the SCO is located in which city?

- (A) Beijing
- (B) Tashkent
- (C) Bishkek
- (D) Moscow

Q3.

Which of the following countries is an observer state of the SCO?

- (A) Pakistan
- (B) Kazakhstan
- (C) Belarus
- (D) Mongolia

Q4.

Assertion (A): The SCO was formally established in Shanghai.

Reason (R): The SCO Charter was signed in 2002.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Council of Heads of Government	A. Border issues and military confidence-building
II. SCO Secretariat	B. Economic and developmental cooperation
III. Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure	C. Permanent administrative body
IV. Shanghai Five	D. Counter-terrorism cooperation

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Read the statements below about the organisation:

- I. The SCO is described as a Permanent Eurasian Inter-Governmental Organisation.
- II. Economic and connectivity cooperation is among the SCO's focus areas.
- III. The SCO is an inter-governmental military alliance, like the Collective Security Treaty Organisation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. China was one of the countries that created the Shanghai Five.
- II. Pakistan is an observer state of the SCO.
- III. Tajikistan is an observer state of the SCO.

- (A) Only two
- (B) All of the above
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only three

India's SCO engagement

India's engagement with the SCO is part of its wider effort to stay active across the Eurasian region. The grouping gives India a multilateral platform where it can meet Russia and China along with several Central Asian republics. India's stated position is that peace, security and stability in the region matter, and that disputes should be settled through dialogue and diplomacy. It also supports inclusive economic development, and it highlights digital cooperation, energy partnerships and green development. India also emphasises people-to-people contacts and cultural linkages with partners. India condemns terrorism in all its forms and supports zero tolerance against it. India's approach allows it to cooperate on issues where its interests align with others while keeping room for independent choices in other matters. The grouping's stated aims include peace, security, stability, economic cooperation and cultural exchange. Its objectives also include building a just, democratic and rational new international order. The SCO is also described as a platform for cooperation, with a focus on peace, prosperity and sustainable development. The SCO allows issue-based alignment, so partners can cooperate on specific questions while differing on others. Such alignment lets India engage with Russia and China on some matters while pursuing its own position on others.

Q1.

Assertion (A): India refuses to join the BRI.

Reason (R): CPEC passes through territories that are disputed.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

Which port and transport corridor reduce dependence on Pakistan-controlled transit for European and Central Asian trade?

- (A) Chabahar Port and INSTC
- (B) Gwadar Port and CPEC
- (C) Hambantota Port and BRI
- (D) Kandla Port and Suez route

Q3.

Through the SCO, India gains institutional access to which group of countries?

- (A) Afghanistan and Mongolia
- (B) Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan
- (C) Iran and Belarus
- (D) Pakistan and China

Q4.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The World Nomad Games were first held in 2014.
 - II. Kok Boru is a traditional Kyrgyz equestrian game in the Nomad Games sports programme.
 - III. India sent no contingent to the 2026 edition of the Nomad Games.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) All of the above
 - (D) Only two

Q5.

Which SCO body treats terror financing and radicalisation as collective regional concerns?

- (A) SCO Secretariat
- (B) Council of Heads of Government
- (C) Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure
- (D) Council of Heads of State

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Soft power pillars in India's SCO vision	A. UNESCO Register of Good Safeguarding Practices
II. Host city of the 6th World Nomad Games 2026	B. Slow progress in payment arrangements and transport corridors
III. Recognition of the Nomad Games initiative	C. Bishkek
IV. Implementation gap in India's SCO engagement	D. Ayurveda and Buddhism

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q7.

Read the statements below about India and the SCO:

- I. India's SCO vision rests on three pillars: Security, Connectivity and Opportunity.
- II. The 6th World Nomad Games 2026 was held in Astana.
- III. The Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure treats terror financing and radicalisation as collective regional concerns.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Reformed Multilateralism: MCQ

The 81st United Nations General Assembly opened on 8 September 2026 in New York, under the theme "Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: A United Nations That Delivers for All." On its sidelines, India's External Affairs Minister co-chaired the inaugural Partners for Multilateralism, International Law, Peace and Prosperity (P4M) Summit with European Council President Antonio Costa. The P4M framework is built on the middle-power solidarity idea that Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney set out at Davos. It was conceived in response to the erosion of global consensus, trade weaponisation and escalating conflicts across Europe and West Asia. Leaders of the European Union, Brazil, Kenya and Canada conceptualised the initiative, and India, Australia and Barbados co-sponsored it. It is designed as an open and flexible framework rather than another exclusive bloc or permanent bureaucracy. Its aims include strengthening international law, peace, multilateral cooperation and prosperity. It also seeks to enable countries from different political traditions to cooperate on reforming multilateral institutions and on common global challenges. At the same sidelines, India's External Affairs Minister took part in the 1st V4 plus India Foreign Ministers' Meeting, held during the Assembly week. India's position on reformed multilateralism was presented within this wider setting.

Q1.

According to India, disruptions involving Fuel, Food, Fertiliser and Finance have a disproportionate impact on which group?

- (A) Developed economies only
- (B) Developing countries and the Global South
- (C) Permanent members of the UN Security Council
- (D) Island states only

Q2.

What did India call for to build more resilient global supply chains?

- (A) Expanded tariffs on imports
- (B) Concentrating production at strategic chokepoints
- (C) Greater reliance on single suppliers
- (D) De-risking and diversification

Q3.

Through which groupings has India consistently pursued UN Security Council reform?

- (A) BRICS and SCO
- (B) G20 and G7
- (C) G4 and L.69
- (D) NAM and ASEAN

Q4.

Assertion (A): Existing multilateral institutions are under pressure.

Reason (R): Geopolitical fragmentation and intensifying strategic competition are placing these institutions under pressure.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Strategic chokepoints	A. Guardrails sought by India
II. Emerging technologies	B. A source of supply-chain risk
III. Global institutions	C. Comprehensive reform
IV. UN Security Council	D. Greater representation of developing countries

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India called for greater transparency in global institutions.
- II. India called for more inclusive decision-making in global institutions.
- III. India argued that the 4F disruptions mainly harm developed economies.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. India called for international frameworks and guardrails for AI, space security and digital technologies.
 - II. India called for building supply chains around a single country's production.
 - III. India pursues UNSC reform through the BRICS grouping.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Visegrad Group: MCQ

The Visegrad Group, usually called the V4, is a grouping that cooperates across several policy areas. Its members took part in a V4 plus India Foreign Ministers' Meeting held on the sidelines of the 81st United Nations General Assembly in New York. The Assembly opened on 8 September 2026 under the theme "Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: A United Nations That Delivers for All." During the same sidelines, India's External Affairs Minister co-chaired the inaugural Partners for Multilateralism, International Law, Peace and Prosperity Summit with European Council President Antonio Costa. The P4M framework is built on the middle-power solidarity idea

that Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney set out at Davos. It was conceived in response to erosion of global consensus, trade weaponisation and escalating conflicts across Europe and West Asia. It is designed as an open and flexible framework rather than an exclusive bloc or a permanent bureaucracy. India's position on reformed multilateralism was also set out during this period. The booklet places these developments within its September 2026 coverage of summits, reports and indices. The V4 meeting is one of the engagements India held with groupings during the Assembly week. It was held alongside the other meetings described in this part of the booklet. The Assembly's theme stresses trust and delivery for all.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Name source of the group	A. Czech Republic, Hungary, Poland and Slovakia
II. Members of the group	B. European Union and NATO
III. Organisations shared by all four members	C. Economic cooperation, energy and culture
IV. Economic and cultural areas of cooperation	D. A town in Hungary

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q2.

In which year was the V4 established?

- (A) 1949
- (B) 2004
- (C) 2010
- (D) 1991

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The V4's cooperation covers energy and culture.
- II. The V4's cooperation excludes defence and security.
- III. The V4 is named after a town in Poland.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I only

Q4.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The V4's cooperation covers political and diplomatic coordination.
 - II. The V4 was established before the end of the Cold War.
 - III. All four V4 members belong to the EU but not to NATO.
- (A) Only three
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only one
 - (D) All of the above

Q5.

Assertion (A): All four V4 members belong to both the European Union and NATO.

Reason (R): The V4 grouping has four member countries.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Which of the following is NOT a member of the V4?

- (A) Poland
- (B) Hungary
- (C) Austria
- (D) Slovakia

Q7.

Which of the following areas is covered by the V4's cooperation?

- (A) Defence and security
- (B) Space exploration
- (C) Maritime fisheries
- (D) Customs union

Arctic Council: MCQ

The Arctic has moved up the international agenda as melting ice opens new maritime corridors, including the Transpolar Sea Route. Control and influence over Arctic sea lanes are expected to shape future global trade and naval power projection. China describes itself as a near-Arctic state and is investing in Arctic research and infrastructure, while Russia has heavily militarised its Arctic coastline. The United States views Greenland as central to countering both. Greenland, the world's largest island, lies between North America and Europe, which gives it a strategic position for monitoring naval movements in the North Atlantic. Pituffik Space Base, formerly known as Thule Air Base, is a US facility for monitoring potential missile threats from Russia, China and North Korea. Denmark's firm stance highlights the tension between territorial sovereignty and the strategic ambitions of major powers. Within this wider competition, the Arctic Council is a platform through which countries discuss the region. Its members are the countries whose territory lies inside the Arctic area, and countries from outside the region also take part in its work. The Council gives these countries a place to talk through issues affecting the Arctic. Its discussions are reported in the booklet's coverage of Arctic affairs. Its members are not the only states with an interest in the region.

Q1.

Through which declaration was the Arctic Council established in 1996?

- (A) Oslo Declaration
- (B) Ottawa Declaration
- (C) Reykjavik Declaration
- (D) Stockholm Declaration

Q2.

Which of the following is NOT a member nation of the Arctic Council?

- (A) Finland
- (B) Norway
- (C) Sweden
- (D) Japan

Q3.

How often does the Arctic Council's chairmanship alternate?

- (A) Every year
- (B) Every 3 years
- (C) Every 2 years
- (D) Every 5 years

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Arctic Council was established in 1996.

Reason (R): It provides a forum for discussion and cooperation on the Arctic environment and sustainable development.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Chair of the Council in 1996-1998	A. Inter-governmental platform
II. India's status in the Council	B. Climate change and its impact on the Arctic region
III. Main focus of the Council	C. Observer since 2013
IV. Type of body	D. Canada

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Arctic Council is an inter-governmental platform.
- II. Greenland is one of the member nations of the Arctic Council.
- III. India has been an observer of the Arctic Council since 2008.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Russia is one of the member nations of the Arctic Council.
- II. The main focus of the Council is maritime trade routes.
- III. The Arctic Council was established in 1996 through the Ottawa Declaration.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

India's Gender Gap Profile

The Global Gender Gap Index is an annual flagship publication of the World Economic Forum. It tracks the extent to which countries have closed gender disparities, rather than simply measuring

women's absolute outcomes. The index has four dimensions: economic participation and opportunity, educational attainment, health and survival, and political empowerment. Each nation is scored from 0 to 1, and the scores are expressed on a 0-100 scale, where 100 represents complete parity. In the 2026 report, India retained its position in the rankings. Its performance is uneven across the dimensions. In educational attainment and in health and survival, India's scores are close to complete parity, and the booklet describes near-complete parity between boys and girls in secondary and tertiary enrolment. Economic participation and political empowerment show far wider gaps. Women are a small share of ministers and of members of the Lok Sabha, and they hold a limited share of senior leadership and managerial posts. In corporate India, women are also few among chief executives and board members. The booklet notes that progress in education and health has not yet carried over to the economic and political dimensions. The booklet also notes that women's share among professional and technical workers has increased, even as women remain under-represented in senior roles. Overall, the booklet presents India's gender gap as a mix of strong and weak dimensions.

Q1.

What was the peak share of women ministers in India, according to the booklet?

- (A) 14.4%
- (B) 5.9%
- (C) 30%
- (D) 13.1%

Q2.

Assertion (A): India's score in economic participation and opportunity is lower than its score in educational attainment.

Reason (R): The index is expressed on a 0-100 scale, where 100 represents complete parity.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

What share of the 18th Lok Sabha elected in 2024 was women?

- (A) 13.6%
- (B) 14.4%
- (C) 13.1%
- (D) 5.9%

Q4.

How many of the following statements about India's performance are correct?

- I. India's score in educational attainment is 96.6%.
- II. Women hold 24.5% of senior leadership and managerial positions in India.
- III. Women hold 13.1% of senior leadership and managerial positions in India.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Women are 17% of CEOs in Indian corporates.
- II. Women are 20% of board members in Indian corporates.
- III. Women are 30% of ministers in India in 2026.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I, II and III
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q6.

According to the 2026 report, what share of ministers in India are women?

- (A) 13.6%
- (B) 5.9%
- (C) 14.4%
- (D) 24.5%

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Educational attainment	A. 24.5%
II. Health and survival	B. 96.6%
III. Economic participation and opportunity	C. 95.6%
IV. Political empowerment	D. 41.2%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Swachh Vayu Diwas Practice Quiz

Swachh Vayu Diwas is an occasion that draws attention to clean air and to the measures taken against air pollution. It is observed alongside an international day that the United Nations General Assembly created to strengthen awareness and international action against air pollution. The occasion is also used to recognise progress, and awards are presented to cities and wards.

The National Clean Air Programme is a national-level strategy that addresses air pollution through coordinated interventions across sectors. It covers non-attainment cities as well as million-plus cities. A non-attainment city is one that has failed to comply with national ambient air quality standards over a specified assessment period.

Progress under the programme is reviewed through the Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan, an annual assessment of cities. The assessment looks at road dust management, solid waste management, vehicular emissions, industrial emissions, construction and demolition waste, commercial sources, and public awareness and outreach. Cities are evaluated on key parameters that cover air quality, action plans and institutional capacity.

Cities are grouped by population into three categories. The first covers cities above 10 lakh people, the second covers cities between 3 and 10 lakh, and the third covers cities below 3 lakh. Rankings are announced separately for each category, so cities are compared with others of similar size.

Q1.

Which ministry organised Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026?

- (A) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- (B) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- (C) Ministry of Jal Shakti
- (D) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

Q2.

In which year did the UN General Assembly designate the International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2017
- (C) 2019
- (D) 2022

Q3.

Which theme was set for the 2026 International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies?

- (A) The Air We Share
- (B) Breathe Life
- (C) Healthy Air, Healthy Planet
- (D) Clean Air for Climate Action

Q4.

On which date was Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026 observed?

- (A) 5 June 2026
- (B) 22 April 2026
- (C) 7 September 2026
- (D) 2 October 2026

Q5.

Consider the following statements about Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026:

- I. Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026 was observed on 7 September 2026.
- II. The 2026 theme of the International Day is 'Breathe Life'.
- III. Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026 was organised by the Ministry of Earth Sciences.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies was designated in 2019.
- II. The 2026 theme of the International Day is 'Clean Air for Climate Action'.
- III. Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026 was observed on 2 October 2026.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Pollution Control Tools and Laws Quiz

India uses a mix of monitoring tools, field measures and legal provisions to tackle air pollution. The National Air Quality Index communicates air quality status in terms that are easy for people to understand, and it is a tool for effective communication with the public. SAFAR, the System of Air

Quality and Weather Forecast and Research, monitors city-wide and localised air quality in Indian metropolises.

Field measures also address pollution from farms. Machines such as the Turbo Happy Seeder are used in the fields, and a bio-decomposer is used to turn crop residue into manure. Emergency action is taken under the Graded Response Action Plan, a set of measures designed to prevent further deterioration of air quality. Vehicle emission standards have been implemented nationwide to reduce vehicular emissions. Both the Turbo Happy Seeder and the Pusa Bio-Decomposer are field-level tools that deal with crop residue.

The legal base includes the Air Act, the Water Act and the Environment Protection Act, which are key pollution control regulations. The Constitution also links the environment to a fundamental duty of citizens, and it has been interpreted to protect the right to a healthy environment. Monitoring, field measures, emergency action and legal provisions together make up the framework described in the booklet.

Q1.

SAFAR is an initiative of which ministry?

- (A) Ministry of Jal Shakti
- (B) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- (C) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment

Q2.

In which year was Bharat Stage VI made mandatory nationwide, marking the leap from BS-IV to BS-VI?

- (A) 2014
- (B) 2017
- (C) 2016
- (D) 2020

Q3.

Which institute developed the Pusa Bio-Decomposer, which turns crop residue into manure in 15-20 days?

- (A) CPCB
- (B) Indian Agricultural Research Institute
- (C) ICAR-CRIDA
- (D) NITI Aayog

Q4.

Graded Response Action Plan measures kick in only when air quality shifts from which category to Very Poor?

- (A) Poor
- (B) Moderate
- (C) Satisfactory
- (D) Good

Q5.

Assertion (A): The Turbo Happy Seeder can uproot stubble.

Reason (R): The Turbo Happy Seeder can also sow seeds in the area it has cleared.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act was enacted in 1981.
- II. The Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act was enacted in 1986.
- III. The Environment Protection Act was enacted in 1986.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Air Quality Index was introduced in 2014.
- II. SAFAR is run by the Central Pollution Control Board.
- III. Bharat Stage VI was made mandatory nationwide in 2020.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only three

Orbits: LEO, MEO and GEO

An orbit is the curved path that a satellite follows around Earth under the influence of gravity. Mission designers must weigh several trade-offs before they choose one, and no single orbit suits every purpose. Earth orbits are classified by altitude, by inclination and by shape. Shape refers to whether an orbit is circular or elliptical, and inclination refers to its tilt relative to the Equator.

Satellites are commonly grouped into three broad families. The first family is Low Earth Orbit, the closest of the three to the planet. Its satellites are widely used for Earth observation and communication, and crewed platforms such as the International Space Station also operate in this zone. Several sub-types exist for particular purposes, including the Sun-synchronous orbit and the Very Low Earth Orbit. Both of these are sub-types of Low Earth Orbit.

The second family is Medium Earth Orbit. Mission planners place it beyond the first family but below the third. The third family is Geosynchronous Orbit, and Geostationary Orbit is a special case within it. Geostationary Orbit is used for communication, weather and imaging. Each family is described in order of increasing distance from Earth, and each differs in altitude, latency and typical use.

Q1.

Approximately how long does one orbit take for a satellite in Low Earth Orbit?

- (A) About 23 hours and 56 minutes
- (B) About 90 to 120 minutes
- (C) About 12 hours
- (D) About 30 days

Q2.

Which orbit family is described as providing a balance between coverage area and signal latency?

- (A) Low Earth Orbit
- (B) Geostationary Orbit
- (C) Very Low Earth Orbit
- (D) Medium Earth Orbit

Q3.

What apparent ground movement may a geosynchronous satellite that is not geostationary show?

- (A) It appears stationary over one point
- (B) It may appear to move North-South
- (C) It moves only East-West
- (D) It circles over the poles

Q4.

Assertion (A): A geostationary satellite appears fixed over one particular point on Earth.

Reason (R): Its orbit lies directly over the Equator with zero-degree inclination and it moves in the same direction as Earth's rotation.

Select the correct option.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Low Earth Orbit	A. Greater atmospheric drag
II. Medium Earth Orbit	B. Altitude of about 35,786 km
III. Very Low Earth Orbit	C. Global navigation satellite systems
IV. Geostationary Orbit	D. Altitude of about 160 to 2,000 km

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about orbits:

- I. Low Earth Orbit satellites are suited to large satellite constellations.
- II. Medium Earth Orbit is primarily used by weather satellites.
- III. Low Earth Orbit offers low communication latency.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about geosynchronous and geostationary satellites are correct?

- I. A geosynchronous satellite's orbital period equals Earth's rotational period.
- II. Medium Earth Orbit lies below the altitude range of Low Earth Orbit.
- III. A geostationary satellite may be inclined to the Equator.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

EOS-05 Imaging Uses

ISRO launched Earth Observation Satellite 05, known as EOS-05, from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre at Sriharikota. The satellite is also called GISAT-1A, and the booklet describes it as India's first dedicated imaging satellite. It is designed to operate from a sub-geosynchronous orbit.

The launch validated India's cryogenic upper-stage technology for future human spaceflight, according to the booklet. The booklet also says it is the heaviest payload a GSLV has injected into orbit. Its launch was the nineteenth operational flight of the GSLV.

A low orbit satellite sees a given location only when it passes overhead, which leaves gaps between observations. A satellite that stays over one region of the planet can instead keep a wide area under watch for long periods. The booklet lists a fixed, 24/7 footprint over the Indian subcontinent as a geostationary advantage. Such platforms are described as useful for tracking cyclones, cloudbursts, flash floods and forest fires.

EOS-05 is equipped with optical and infrared imaging payloads, and its applications are presented under three headings: disaster management, strategic and national security, and agriculture and environment. Each heading is linked to a set of monitoring tasks, and the booklet lists examples under each one. The booklet presents these points together in a short summary of the satellite and its applications.

Q1.

Which of these is NOT one of the application areas that the booklet gives for EOS-05?

- (A) Disaster management
- (B) Strategic and national security
- (C) Agriculture and environment
- (D) Urban transport planning

Q2.

Which of these is NOT listed as a purpose that frequent observations can support?

- (A) Weather monitoring
- (B) Early warning
- (C) Emergency response
- (D) Mineral exploration

Q3.

How does the booklet describe cyclones, cloudbursts, flash floods and forest fires?

- (A) Slow-moving climate trends
- (B) Rapidly developing events
- (C) Seasonal crop events
- (D) Deep-sea currents

Q4.

Assertion (A): Crop insurance claims can be settled using objective satellite indices.

Reason (R): Satellite indices replace manual experiments in the claim process.

Select the correct option.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Optical sensors	A. Continuous surveillance of land borders and maritime domain
II. High altitude	B. Monitoring of forest fires, vegetation health and crop cycles
III. Strategic and national security	C. Cannot penetrate thick clouds
IV. Agriculture and environment	D. Limits sub-meter spatial resolution

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about EOS-05 applications:

- I. Frequent observations can support early warning and emergency response.
- II. Strategic security applications include enhancing situational awareness.
- III. Disaster management applications include tracking the maritime domain.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about EOS-05 are correct?

- I. EOS-05 enables gapless cyclone tracking.
- II. Crop insurance claims rely on manual field experiments rather than satellite indices.
- III. Forest fire monitoring is part of the strategic and national security application area.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

EU Associate Membership Proposal

European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen has proposed exploring a new form of relationship that could enable Canada to become an 'Associate Member' of the European Union. The proposal is linked to an 'Alliance for the Future', which would promote greater cooperation between Europe and Canada in areas such as defence, critical supply chains, technology, clean energy, strategic industries and Arctic security. The idea is presented as a possible new model of engagement between the EU and a non-EU country. Under such an arrangement, Canada could participate more closely in selected European frameworks without becoming a full member. Participation could cover selected EU programmes, cooperation in defence procurement and collaboration in emerging technologies. However, it would not automatically provide EU institutional membership, voting rights, representation in the European Parliament or automatic access to the Single Market. The term 'Associate Member' is not an established membership category under the EU's foundational treaties. One route would be formal treaty revision, which would require the relevant EU treaties to be amended. Such an arrangement could establish special economic cooperation, institutional dialogue and sector-specific integration without formally creating a new category of EU membership.

Q1.

Which article of the Treaty on the Functioning of the European Union is cited for negotiating a special Association Agreement?

- (A) Article 210
- (B) Article 294
- (C) Article 217
- (D) Article 235

Q2.

Which EU bodies must give approval for an Association Agreement?

- (A) Unanimous approval in the Council and consent of the European Parliament
- (B) Approval by the European Commission alone
- (C) Qualified majority approval in the European Council only
- (D) Ratification by the national parliaments of all member states

Q3.

In which city did 128 countries reach a consensus on a working definition of Lethal Autonomous Weapons Systems under the UN Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons?

- (A) Washington, D.C.
- (B) Vienna
- (C) New York
- (D) Geneva

Q4.

Assertion (A): Formal treaty revision is a route that is hard to achieve for creating a new category of EU membership.

Reason (R): All 27 EU Member States would have to agree to a treaty revision.

- (A) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Vienna Convention	A. 2016
II. Montreal Protocol	B. 1973
III. Kigali Amendment	C. 1987
IV. CITES	D. 1985

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The CCW was adopted in 1980 and entered into force in 1983.
- II. An Association Agreement needs approval only by the European Commission.
- III. Treaty revision would require ratification according to the constitutional procedures of individual Member States.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Montreal Protocol led to a 99% phase-out of controlled ozone-depleting substances.
- II. CITES species are listed in three appendices by conservation status and trade sensitivity.
- III. The Kigali Amendment mandates the phase-out of hydrofluorocarbons.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Political Funding, Time Standard and Schemes

The PM Vishwakarma scheme completed three years of implementation in September 2026. It supports traditional artisans with a focus on district saturation, brand promotion and market linkages. The scheme covers 18 traditional trades in rural and urban areas, and its benefits are meant for artisans in the unorganised sector. Beneficiaries receive an ID card, and the scheme offers basic and advanced training.

Concerns over political funding transparency have intensified amid allegations involving registered unrecognised political parties. A political party can apply to the Election Commission of India for registration under the Representation of the People Act, 1951. Registered parties must maintain records of specified contributions, file annual contribution reports and comply with audit and tax requirements. The Election Commission maintains and publishes information on registered, delisted and disputed parties, and such parties may receive certain electoral benefits.

The Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026 have been notified by the Department of Consumer Affairs. They make Indian Standard Time the single mandatory time reference for legal, administrative, commercial and official purposes across India. The rules are part of the 'One Nation, One Time' initiative, promote the use of NavIC and will come into force 180 days after their publication in the Official Gazette.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about Indian Standard Time:

- I. IST is based on 82.5 degrees East longitude.
- II. IST is 5 hours 30 minutes ahead of Coordinated Universal Time.
- III. The Standard Meridian of IST passes through Tamil Nadu.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

Under which Article of the Constitution does the superintendence, direction and control of elections vest in the Election Commission of India?

- (A) Article 19(1)(a)
- (B) Article 345
- (C) Article 324
- (D) Article 347

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Section 29A of RPA, 1951	A. Tax exemptions for eligible parties
II. Section 29B of RPA, 1951	B. Contribution reports
III. Section 29C of RPA, 1951	C. Voluntary contributions from individuals and companies
IV. Section 13A of Income Tax Act, 1961	D. Registration of political parties

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q4.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The PM Vishwakarma scheme is fully funded by the Government of India.
 - II. Only one member per family can apply for the scheme's benefits.
 - III. Applicants who benefited from PM Swanidhi in the past five years are eligible to apply.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Q5.

Under Section 52 of which Act were the Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026 notified?

- (A) Legal Metrology Act, 2009
- (B) Representation of the People Act, 1951
- (C) Companies Act, 2013
- (D) Income Tax Act, 1961

Q6.

Which institution is the custodian of India's national time standard?

- (A) Raman Research Institute
- (B) Indian Space Research Organisation
- (C) National Informatics Centre
- (D) CSIR-National Physical Laboratory

Space, Orangutans and Film Awards

NASA's Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope has been launched to study dark energy, dark matter and exoplanets. It is designed to complement the Hubble and James Webb space telescopes and to investigate the structure of galaxies. Its international collaborators include the European Space Agency and the Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency.

Five young orangutans were rescued in Odisha and moved to a zoo. Orangutans are arboreal, spending much of their lives in trees, and their natural range is tropical forests.

World Rhino Day is observed on 22 September to raise awareness about the conservation of the world's five remaining rhinoceros species. The day was declared by WWF in 2010. The International Rhino Foundation releases an annual assessment of rhino populations, called the State of Rhino Report, which examines population trends, conservation status and major threats to rhino survival.

The National Film Awards recognise films and cinematic writing. They are announced by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, and the President of India presents the awards at a formal ceremony, traditionally held in New Delhi. The awards cover works produced in different Indian languages and regions, including feature films, non-feature films and writing on cinema, and they honour films from the 2024 calendar year.

Q1.

Which rhinoceros species is the largest of the five and is concentrated in Kaziranga National Park, Assam?

- (A) African White Rhinoceros
- (B) Javan Rhinoceros
- (C) Greater One-Horned Rhinoceros
- (D) Sumatran Rhinoceros

Q2.

Which national park is home to the last remaining wild Javan rhinos?

- (A) Kaziranga National Park
- (B) Ujung Kulon National Park
- (C) Jaldapara National Park
- (D) Dudhwa Tiger Reserve

Q3.

What is the 2026 theme of World Rhino Day?

- (A) Save the Last Rhino
- (B) One Horn, One Future
- (C) Rhinos Forever
- (D) Keep the Five Alive

Q4.

Assertion (A): International commercial trade in orangutans is prohibited.

Reason (R): Orangutans are covered by CITES, the convention on international trade in endangered wild fauna and flora.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Cosmic Dark Ages	A. Proposed lunar-orbiting satellite
II. PRATUSH	B. Launched aboard a SpaceX Falcon Heavy
III. Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope	C. Period after CMB formation and before first stars
IV. CosmoCube	D. Indigenous radio-astronomy project

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about orangutans and rhinos:

- I. Orangutans are native to India.
- II. The word orangutan originates from the Malay language.
- III. The Greater One-Horned Rhinoceros is identified by a single black horn.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope operates near the Sun-Earth L2 point.
- II. The National Film Awards were established in 1973.
- III. The Directorate of Film Festivals has administered the National Film Awards since 1973.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Upper Bhadra Trial Run

The September 2026 current affairs compilation for AILET preparation opens its governance section with an item on the Upper Bhadra Project and the Bhadra River. The item reports that a successful trial run of the Upper Bhadra Project enabled water from the Bhadra Reservoir to reach Gonur Lake in Chitradurga district. During the run, the water moved through a canal that forms part of the project's route. The booklet presents the trial as the start of the project's operational phase. It also says the development fulfils a demand for reliable water supply that has existed for a long time in parts of central Karnataka. The Upper Bhadra entry is the first item on its booklet page. The Ladakh and national accounts entries also appear on that page. The page is headed September 2026 and carries the label Topic in News. A separate item on India's national accounts appears under the economy heading on the same page. The compilation groups its items under headings such as governance, economy, environment and awards. The national accounts entry says the revised series uses 2022-23 as its base year. The Ladakh entry is the second item under the governance heading on that page. Each entry is written as a short list of points beneath its heading.

Q1.

Through which canal did the trial-run water travel to Gonur Lake?

- (A) Gonur Feeder Canal
- (B) Koodli Branch Canal
- (C) Chitradurga Branch Canal
- (D) Bhadra Reservoir Main Canal

Q2.

The Upper Bhadra Project is the first irrigation project in Karnataka to receive which status from the Union Government?

- (A) Special Irrigation Status
- (B) National Project Status
- (C) State Priority Status
- (D) Union Territory Status

Q3.

Near which peak does the Bhadra River originate in the Western Ghats?

- (A) Tunga Peak
- (B) Koodli Peak
- (C) Gonur Peak
- (D) Gangamoola Peak

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Bhadra River flows directly into the Krishna River.

Reason (R): The Bhadra River joins the Tunga River at Koodli, near Shivamogga.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Bhadra River originates in	A. Bay of Bengal
II. Bhadra joins Tunga River at	B. Western Ghats
III. Tungabhadra River is a tributary of	C. Koodli
IV. Krishna river system drains into	D. Krishna River

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Bhadra River joins the Tunga River at Koodli.
- II. The Tungabhadra River is a tributary of the Godavari River.
- III. The Krishna river system drains into the Bay of Bengal.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

The Bhadra River rises in the Western Ghats.

The Tungabhadra River is formed at Gangamoola Peak.

The Krishna river system drains into the Ganga.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Ladakh Constitutional Framework

The governance section of the September 2026 current affairs compilation contains an item on a proposed Special Constitutional Framework for Ladakh. The item describes the proposal as a new chapter under Article 371. According to the item, the framework is expected to give a Union Territory level institution powers over matters that are particularly important to the region. The item also notes that other areas of legislative authority applicable to Union Territories may form part of the proposal. The Upper Bhadra Project item appears first in the same governance section. The national accounts item appears under the economy heading on that same page. The compilation groups its items under headings such as governance, economy, environment and awards. Each entry in the compilation carries a short list of points, and the Ladakh entry follows the same pattern. The page is headed September 2026 and carries the label Topic in News. The Upper Bhadra entry reports a trial run that carried water from the Bhadra Reservoir to Gonur Lake in Chitradurga district. The national accounts entry says that the revised series uses 2022-23 as its base year. On that page, the governance entries come before the economy entry. The Ladakh entry is the second item under the governance heading.

Q1.

Which ministry proposed the new chapter under Article 371 for Ladakh?

- (A) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (B) Ministry of Law and Justice
- (C) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- (D) Ministry of Jal Shakti

Q2.

The proposed Union Territory level institution for Ladakh is envisaged as which type of body?

- (A) Nominated Advisory Body
- (B) Appointed Executive Council
- (C) Directly Elected Legislative Body
- (D) Judicial Tribunal

Q3.

Other areas of legislative authority applicable to Union Territories under which article may also form part of the proposal?

- (A) Article 370
- (B) Article 371
- (C) Article 240
- (D) Article 245

Q4.

Assertion (A): The proposed institution for Ladakh is expected to receive powers over land matters alone.

Reason (R): The expected powers include local culture, traditions and language, and forests, environment and natural resources.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Which of the following is listed among the matters the proposed institution is expected to receive powers over?

- (A) Foreign policy
- (B) Local culture, traditions and language
- (C) Taxation of companies
- (D) Defence and armed forces

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Ministry of Home Affairs proposed a new chapter under Article 371 for Ladakh.
- II. The proposed institution would have no powers over land.
- III. The proposed institution is expected to receive powers over forests and natural resources.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

The proposal is a new chapter under Article 371.

The proposed body would be appointed rather than directly elected.

The item names the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation as the proposer.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

National Accounts Revision

The economy heading of the September 2026 current affairs compilation carries an item on India's revised national accounts methodology. The item states that the revised series was released in 2026 and that it introduces several methodological changes. The revision seeks to reflect structural changes in the economy, to use improved and newer data sources, and to update statistical methodologies. It also aims for constant-price estimates that more accurately reflect the contemporary economy. The national accounts entry is set out as a list of points, in the same format as the other entries on the page. The page is headed September 2026 and carries the label Topic in News. The governance heading above the economy entry contains the Upper Bhadra Project item. That governance section also includes the proposal for Ladakh, which follows the Upper Bhadra item. The compilation groups its items under headings such as governance, economy, environment and awards. The economy heading on this page holds only the national accounts entry. The Upper Bhadra entry reports a trial run that carried water from the Bhadra Reservoir to Gonur Lake in

Chitradurga district. The next booklet page opens with an environment item on India's first Blue Bond. The booklet's running header names the AILET Corner series.

Q1.

Which ministry released India's revised National Accounts Series in 2026?

- (A) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
- (B) Ministry of Finance
- (C) Ministry of Home Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Jal Shakti

Q2.

The revised series adopts which financial year as its new base year?

- (A) 2019-20
- (B) 2020-21
- (C) 2022-23
- (D) 2023-24

Q3.

Which method is adopted for Manufacturing Gross Value Added in the revision?

- (A) Single deflation
- (B) Double deflation
- (C) Triple deflation
- (D) Net deflation

Q4.

Assertion (A): National accounts measure only the production of goods in an economy.

Reason (R): National accounts measure production, income, expenditure, consumption, investment, saving and external trade.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

The estimates in the revised series are prepared broadly in line with which system?

- (A) World Bank Accounting Code
- (B) Ministry Statistical Manual
- (C) Regional Accounts Charter
- (D) United Nations System of National Accounts

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The revised series uses 2022-23 as its new base year.
- II. The revision was released by the Ministry of Home Affairs.
- III. National accounts measure saving and external trade.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

The revision adopts double deflation for Manufacturing Gross Value Added.

The estimates are prepared broadly in line with the UN System of National Accounts.

The revision uses 2019-20 as its new base year.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Type-in-the-answer passages

Peace Deals Recall

Yemen's civil war has moved through phases of fighting, negotiation and fragile truces. After the Houthis took over large parts of the north, a Saudi-led coalition joined the conflict to support the government that is recognised internationally. Renewed fighting caused civilian displacement and disrupted local supply lines. Negotiators from the warring parties then tried to find a way out of the fighting through a package of agreements. The Stockholm Agreement was one such deal, and it covered several issues, including the city of Hodeidah and its ports. Ceasefire terms for Hodeidah set out how armed forces would move away from the ports and how the ports would be run by local forces. The agreements were meant to reduce violence and open a path to a wider political settlement. Diplomats kept returning to the talks table, hoping that partial deals could be turned into lasting arrangements.

Q1.

The Stockholm Agreement was reached on which day of December 2018? (day of the month)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which UN Security Council resolution number was the Stockholm Agreement endorsed?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many main components does the Stockholm Agreement have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the Hodeidah ceasefire, the withdrawal of forces is overseen by a committee chaired by which organisation? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under the Hodeidah ceasefire, which party was to withdraw from the ports and Hodeidah City? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did the Saudi-led military intervention in Yemen begin? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

From midnight on which day of December 2018 did the Hodeidah ceasefire take effect? (day of the month)

Answer: _____

Dispute mechanism: typed answers

The Indus Waters Treaty sets out a graded system for handling disagreements between India and Pakistan. A standing bilateral body is meant to handle questions through discussion and exchange of information. Where a disagreement is technical rather than legal, it can be passed to an independent expert whose appointment is arranged through an outside institution. Formal legal disputes are meant to reach a court of arbitration, which is constituted under a formal annex to the treaty and has a fixed number of members. Both countries have at times run proceedings along two tracks at the same time, which has raised concerns about conflicting outcomes. When one such track was paused and later resumed, the order of steps became a central point of argument. India holds that the treaty must be followed in sequence, so that a legal tribunal takes up a case only after the earlier steps are exhausted. Pakistan has pursued its own route through arbitration. Meanwhile, restrictions on construction at one hydroelectric project remain linked to the outcome of the expert's work and stay in force for a period after the expert issues its final decision. The dispute has shown how much depends on the procedural order laid down in the treaty.

Q1.

How many members does the Court of Arbitration under the Indus Waters Treaty have? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which Annexure of the Indus Waters Treaty is the Court of Arbitration constituted?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which institution's mechanism is involved in appointing the Neutral Expert? (name the institution)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did the World Bank pause both the arbitration and Neutral Expert processes?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did the World Bank allow both processes to move forward?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which 850 MW hydroelectric project on the Chenab River has restrictions imposed by the tribunal? (name the project)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Ratle project restrictions remain relevant until how many days after the Neutral Expert's final determination? (in days)

Answer: _____

Union history TITA set

The United Kingdom was built in stages, and its constituent nations joined it at different times. Wales was brought into the English legal and political system through an Act of Union passed in

the sixteenth century. The English and Scottish parliaments were united in 1707, creating a single new state. Ireland joined later, when another Act of Union brought it into the United Kingdom. Most of Ireland became independent after an Anglo-Irish War, while six counties in the north remained within the United Kingdom as Northern Ireland. Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland now each have devolved institutions, but the extent of their powers differs. Scotland's Parliament and Wales's legislature were set up by separate Acts of Parliament, and Westminster retains ultimate constitutional authority over all of these arrangements. After Brexit, Northern Ireland came to share a land border with an EU member state. New checks were then introduced between Great Britain and Northern Ireland, and these checks angered Unionists who believed they undermined Northern Ireland's position within the UK. This layered history explains why devolution differs across the nations, and why these tensions continue to shape political debate.

Q1.

In which year was the Act of Union that brought Ireland into the United Kingdom passed?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was Wales incorporated into the English legal and political system?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did most of Ireland become independent?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Name the Act of Parliament that established the Scottish Parliament.

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was the state called that was formed when the English and Scottish parliaments were united in 1707? (use the full name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Good Friday Agreement signed?

Answer: _____

Legal tools check

Trade measures linked to Russian energy purchases raise questions about how long they will last. A measure that has been passed by the legislature and signed into federal law carries greater legal permanence. American trade policy also relies on older statutes that give the government tools to respond to foreign practices. One of these allows the trade representative to examine unfair conduct by other countries. Another permits restrictions on imports when they are seen as a risk to national security. The government has also used tariffs on certain imported metals, and it has applied tariffs connected with goods produced through forced labour. For a country like India, such instruments matter because they change the cost of exports and make trade talks more complicated. Officials and businesses often watch these tools closely because a single measure can affect many sectors at once. Understanding the legal route behind each tariff helps explain why some measures last longer than others.

Q1.

In which year did the U.S. Supreme Court strike down the broader tariff regime that included the earlier 25% punitive tariff on India? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Trade Expansion Act, under which Section 232 operates, enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which section of the Trade Act, 1974 can the USTR investigate foreign trade practices? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

On which legal instrument was the earlier 25% punitive tariff on India based? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What must accompany a presidential waiver under the new Act when it is placed before Congress? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What tariff rate, in per cent, has the United States imposed on steel, aluminium and copper products? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What tariff rate, in per cent, does India face in connection with a U.S. investigation into goods produced using forced labour? (number)

Answer: _____

Disputed Lines: TITA Set

The boundary between India and China has never been fully settled, and disagreements over it have produced a long chain of confrontations. Two stretches of the frontier sit at the heart of the dispute. One lies in the high region of Aksai Chin, which the two sides understand differently, each relying on its own historical line. The other involves Arunachal Pradesh, which China describes as part of Tibet while India administers it as a full state. The line in that area was agreed at a convention attended by Tibet, China and British India, but China refused to accept it, arguing that Tibet could not conclude treaties. Armed encounters and standoffs have since erupted in several places, including mountain passes in Sikkim and Arunachal and the plateau where three countries meet. A practical dividing line emerged after the war of the early 1960s, and both sides have since tried to prevent escalation through talks and confidence-building measures. Local commanders meet at designated points to resolve friction on the ground, while senior commanders negotiate withdrawals when standoffs become serious. Yet incidents continue in the high mountains. Understanding these disputed lines is therefore essential for reading news about the border, since each claim carries a long history behind it.

Q1.

China administers Aksai Chin as part of which autonomous region? (name the region)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the McMahon Line demarcated? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

On which date in 1962 did China unilaterally declare a ceasefire? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Into how many sectors is the Line of Actual Control divided? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Chinese Premier introduced the term 'Line of Actual Control' in 1959? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which sector of the LAC covers Arunachal Pradesh and Sikkim? (name the sector)

Answer: _____

Q7.

For how many days did the 2017 Doklam plateau standoff last? (in days)

Answer: _____

Equal Earth and the Correct the Map campaign

A world map has to make choices, and the projection behind it decides which features look accurate. Many wall maps have long used a projection that suits navigation but makes landmasses far from the Equator look larger than they really are. Equal Earth is a newer world projection designed to display the entire globe while keeping the relative sizes of landmasses accurate. It avoids the severe, jarring shape distortions found in earlier equal-area maps. A campaign called Correct the Map has urged the wider use of equal-area projections, and two advocacy groups run it. Regional bodies have endorsed the idea, and the matter was taken up by the United Nations General Assembly. The resolution received wide support, but it also drew opposition and abstentions in the vote. Such a resolution carries political weight, yet it does not have binding force. Schools, publishers and governments are therefore free to decide whether to change the maps they use. Maps shape how people picture the size and position of countries. Choosing a projection is therefore a practical decision that depends on the purpose of the map. Readers should check what a map is designed to show before drawing conclusions from it. Only time will show whether the new map becomes common in classrooms and official documents.

Q1.

Which country led the UN General Assembly 'Correct the Map' resolution? (name the country)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many countries supported the resolution, including India? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which country voted against the resolution? (name the country)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many countries abstained from the vote on the resolution? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which regional organisation endorsed the Correct the Map campaign in August 2025? (give the name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Equal Earth projection created? (in year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Togolese Foreign Minister is associated with the resolution? (give the full name)

Answer: _____

Electoral Rolls and SIR: Typed Answer Set

An electoral roll is the official list of individuals eligible to vote in a given election within a specific jurisdiction, and being listed on it is a legal prerequisite for casting a vote in India. The publishing and updating of electoral rolls are the joint responsibility of the Election Commission of India, the state's Chief Electoral Officer and the state's election commission. The Commission has broad authority over voter list management, and no individual may be excluded from electoral rolls on grounds of religion, race, caste or sex. The Commission can direct a fresh revision of rolls, which may be intensive, summary or a combination of both. An intensive revision involves a complete and fresh preparation of rolls through house-to-house enumeration, and it is done when the rolls are outdated, inaccurate or need complete rebuilding. A summary revision is a routine annual updating of existing rolls, while a special revision is undertaken in exceptional cases. The Special Intensive Revision is a focused, time-bound house-to-house verification of voters by Booth Level Officers, aimed at adding missing voters, removing ineligible ones and correcting entries. Such a revision excludes non-citizens and includes citizens aged 18 or above who are ordinarily resident in the constituency. Courts have also held that names cannot be removed from voter lists merely on suspicion, and the right to vote is treated as a statutory right rather than a fundamental one.

Q1.

In which year did the earliest Special Intensive Revision listed in the booklet begin? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many documents from the prescribed list can be submitted in the Bihar SIR to prove date or place of birth? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the last SIR held in Bihar? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

The 61st Amendment (1988) reduced the minimum voting age from how many years? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which 1995 case struck down ECI guidelines that allowed deletion from electoral rolls on mere suspicion? (name of the first party)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which section of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 can the ECI direct a fresh revision of electoral rolls? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Article does the ECI have supervisory and controlling authority over elections and electoral rolls? (article number)

Answer: _____

Schemes and Partnerships in Brief

India's push into semiconductors uses several kinds of government support rather than a single measure. Some tools are aimed at manufacturing, with financial incentives for companies that set up production within the country and attract large investments. Others are aimed at design, because a country that can design its own chips depends less on imported technology. Academic institutions and start-ups are part of this effort, as they need access to specialised resources, training facilities and design infrastructure. Research bodies are also building their own processors, including designs based on an open instruction architecture, which adds to domestic technical strength. Support for design firms is planned over a long stretch so that they can move from early development to full deployment. Diplomacy plays a role as well. India has signed a strategic technology agreement with a major economy to expand cooperation in research, business and defence industry. It has also joined a coalition of countries that wish to protect the supply of critical minerals, manufacturing capacity and digital infrastructure. Together these steps reflect an attempt to lower dependence on other countries and to become a dependable part of the global chip supply network, which matters greatly in a world where supply disruptions can hurt many industries at once.

Q1.

In which year did India sign the India-US iCET deal? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What budgetary provision, in crore rupees, has been made for FY 2026-27 to support India Semiconductor Mission 2.0? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

For how many years does the Design-Linked Incentive scheme provide support to semiconductor design companies? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the name of the coalition India joined to strengthen global semiconductor supply-chain resilience? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What range of domestic production-linked incentives does the PLI scheme offer to mobile phone and specified component makers? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

At which institution was the ChipIN Centre established? (short name)

Answer: _____

Exemptions and caps check

Digital payments work best when small transactions stay cheap for everyone who uses them. Small businesses need protection from additional payment processing costs. Policymakers have therefore tried to protect the smallest users while still asking larger participants to share the cost of running the network. The new approach separates payments into groups. Some payments remain free regardless of who sends or receives them, while others attract a charge only when they are large. Certain sectors that provide essential services are placed in a separate group, where a fixed charge per transaction applies rather than a percentage. Investments routed through mutual funds and securities are charged at a lower rate, because that rate is meant to encourage greater use of digital payments in formal financial markets. Several upper limits also protect users. A single ceiling prevents very large payments from carrying an unlimited fee, and small merchants who earn only modest amounts through QR codes each month are exempt from the charge altogether. Together, these rules aim to keep ordinary digital payments affordable while the payment infrastructure keeps growing.

Q1.

Which type of UPI payment between two individuals is exempt from MDR? Give the standard abbreviation.

Answer: _____

Q2.

Up to what amount, in rupees, are P2M UPI payments exempt from MDR, including through RuPay debit cards?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What monthly receipt limit, in lakh rupees, keeps small merchants under the P2PM UPI QR category exempt from MDR?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the maximum MDR, in rupees per transaction, for transactions of ₹75,000 and above?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What reduced MDR, in per cent, applies to payments involving mutual funds, securities, stock brokers and stock dealers?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of the category that contains mutual funds and securities in the MDR table? Give two words.

Answer: _____

Agriculture, Health and Climate TITA

The 18th BRICS Summit also produced outcomes in areas that touch everyday life, including farming, public health, transport and climate. Member countries discussed how to make food supplies steadier, particularly when global prices move sharply. A proposed commodity marketplace was among the ideas, intended to make trade in farm produce among member countries more predictable. Cooperation on seeds, plant material and farm inputs was also highlighted, along with a farmer-centred framework for sharing information. In health, the focus was on promoting active living and on building support for mental well-being through shared training. Innovation in medicine was another theme, with attention to developing solutions that

could be deployed widely in developing regions. On transport and logistics, members agreed to share technical knowledge about building resilient supply systems. Climate concerns were reflected in discussions about cleaner fuels for aviation, urban infrastructure able to withstand extreme weather, and the protection of natural carbon sinks such as tropical forests. Culinary exchanges were also part of the summit, with regional produce showcased to delegates. Together, these outcomes reflected an effort to link economic cooperation with practical improvements in people's livelihoods.

Q1.

By which year does BRICS aim to launch the BRICS Grain Exchange? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Indian institution leads the Training Hub Network for mental well-being?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which state's MedTech Zone spearheaded the BRICS BioDesign Centre? (name of state)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year does the Joint Roadmap for Healthy Lifestyle Promotion end? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year does the Global Value Chains Action Plan end? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which BRICS network focuses on cooperation relating to seeds, germplasm and agricultural inputs?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Delegates were served Koraput Coffee from which Indian state?

Answer: _____

SCO origins: typed answers

The organisation's story begins with a grouping built to settle old disputes. Its early members were mainly concerned with borders between neighbours and with building trust among their armed forces. Over time, the group admitted new members and widened its agenda from border questions to security, trade and people-to-people contact. Membership has grown in stages, and some countries first took part as observers before becoming full members. Today the organisation has a secretariat that handles routine administration, and a council of heads of state that takes the most important decisions. Its counter-terrorism work runs through a regional structure based in Uzbekistan. The chairmanship moves between member states each year, which keeps the organisation's leadership spread across the region. Its leaders also meet at the annual summit, where the chair passes from one member to the next. The organisation's objectives include strengthening mutual trust, good-neighbourliness and mutual support on security and counter-terrorism. It also aims to promote cooperation in trade, economy, connectivity, transport, digital economy and environmental protection. Over the years, members have built a shared set of institutions, and their common work is coordinated through the secretariat and the heads of state council. The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation describes its goals as peace, security, stability, economic cooperation and cultural exchange in the SCO region.

Q1.

In which year was the Shanghai Five created? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which country joined the Shanghai Five in 2001, leading to the SCO's establishment? (country)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did the SCO Charter enter into force? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did Belarus become a full member of the SCO? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did India become an SCO observer? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many outcome documents did leaders approve at the 26th SCO Summit? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which city is the headquarters of the SCO? (city)

Answer: _____

Greenland and the US Agreement

Greenland, the world's largest island, lies between North America and Europe, which makes it a linchpin in Arctic and trans-Atlantic security. It is one of Denmark's two autonomous territories, and it is self-governing. Greenland lies within the GIUK gap, a strategic chokepoint for monitoring naval movements in the North Atlantic. The United States maintains Pituffik Space Base, formerly known as Thule Air Base, which is a pivotal facility for monitoring potential missile threats. A new trilateral agreement among the United States, Denmark and Greenland builds on earlier defence arrangements while recognising Greenland's right to self-determination. It provides for expanded activities at Pituffik and for US military access to Narsarsuaq in southern Greenland, along with broader operational access across Greenland's land, air and maritime areas. The agreement restricts military presence by non-NATO states through joint approval, and it does not transfer sovereignty over Greenland to the United States. Beyond security, Greenland holds large untapped reserves of rare earth minerals, and melting Arctic ice is opening new maritime corridors such as the Transpolar Sea Route. Denmark's firm stance highlights the tension between territorial sovereignty and the strategic ambitions of major powers.

Q1.

In which year did the US-Denmark Defence Agreement concerning Greenland formalise American military access to the island? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the expedition led by Hans Egede arrive in Greenland, after which it became a Danish colony? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What was the amount of the 1946 US offer to Denmark for an outright purchase of Greenland? (in million US dollars, number only)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which island, recognised as the world's northernmost point of land, is located in the Greenland region? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many Arctic nations are members of the Arctic Council? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Since which year has Greenland had the right to declare independence through a referendum? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Indian Arctic research station, established in 2008, is located at Ny-Alesund in Svalbard, Norway? (one word)

Answer: _____

Global Progress Check

Global progress toward gender equality is measured through rankings and overall scores, and the latest edition offers a mixed picture. The top of the table has stayed remarkably stable, with the same country holding the leading position for a long stretch. Several nations close behind it have also kept strong positions. Movement at the bottom of the table is watched closely, since the lowest-ranked countries show the widest gaps. Across the world, the overall gap has narrowed, but only slightly from the previous year, which means change is slow. Leadership remains a challenge in every sphere. Women hold only a small share of chief executive roles, and their presence in emerging technology work is also limited. Career patterns add to the picture, since women are more likely than men to take breaks from work linked to parenting. One new country joined the group of top performers for the first time in this edition. Taken together, these trends suggest that closing gaps requires sustained effort rather than occasional improvement.

Q1.

For how many consecutive years has Iceland retained the first position? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which country ranked last among the 145 countries covered in the 2026 index?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What share of the overall global gender gap has the world closed? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q4.

At the present rate of progress, approximately how many years would complete global gender parity take? (in years)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What per cent of CEO positions globally are held by women? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country entered the global top 10 for the first time in 2026?

Answer: _____

NCAP numbers check

The National Clean Air Programme is a national-level strategy launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change to address air pollution through coordinated interventions across sectors. It covers non-attainment cities along with million-plus cities. Non-attainment cities are those that have failed to comply with the National Ambient Air Quality Standards over a specified assessment period. Its initial target was a 20 to 30 per cent reduction in PM10 and PM2.5 concentrations by 2024. Later, the target was enhanced to a reduction in particulate matter concentration by 2026, and the revised target has not been fully achieved. Annual PM10 concentrations are compared with the base year to measure progress. Progress is also tracked through the PRANA portal, which was launched to track NCAP progress and regulate air pollution in non-attainment cities. The National Air Quality Index is a tool for communicating air quality status to people in terms that are easy to understand. The Graded Response Action Plan is a set of emergency measures that come into effect when air quality shifts from Poor to Very Poor. Other measures include the Bharat Stage VI vehicle emission standards, which replaced BS-IV norms nationwide.

Q1.

In which year was the National Clean Air Programme launched by MoEFCC? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many of the 130 cities recorded a reduction of 40% or more in particulate matter concentration? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many cities met the prescribed NAAQS under NCAP progress? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the baseline for NCAP targets set? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

To what percentage reduction in particulate matter concentration by 2026 was the NCAP target enhanced? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many cities achieved reductions of more than 20% in FY 2025-26? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many cities recorded reductions in annual PM10 concentrations in 2025-26 compared to 2017-18? (in number)

Answer: _____

NISAR radar check

The NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar satellite, called NISAR in short, is a partnership between two space agencies and is described as the first joint Earth-observation satellite of its kind between them. Conventional cameras depend on visible light, but radar works differently. A synthetic aperture radar sends microwave pulses toward the ground and builds images from the returning signals, so it can produce sharp pictures in darkness and through clouds. The satellite is meant to study changes in the solid Earth. Its images help track surface deformation, which is useful for understanding earthquakes, volcanic activity and landslides. The same data can also support monitoring of floods, biomass, deforestation, crop health and soil moisture. The booklet calls its radar technology among the finest synthetic aperture radar systems ever designed. Its large receiving antenna and wide imaging swath make it suitable for mapping large surface areas in three dimensions. Because the satellite can detect minute ground shifts, its data is used for tectonic and structural analysis.

Q1.

What is NISAR's designed mission life, in years?

Answer: _____

Q2.

At what altitude, in km, does NISAR orbit Earth?

Answer: _____

Q3.

After how many days does NISAR's repeat cycle complete? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the width of NISAR's imaging swath, in km?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many radar frequency bands does NISAR use? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which type of low Earth orbit does NISAR use?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the name of NISAR's imaging mode that captures wide 3D high-resolution images?

Answer: _____

Economy and Schemes: Key Numbers

Several economic and infrastructure stories were in the news this month. The Union Cabinet approved a scheme to promote new surface coal and lignite gasification projects that produce syngas, building on the National Coal Gasification Mission launched in 2021. Gasification converts coal into a gaseous fuel instead of burning it directly, and the scheme is part of a wider national objective for coal gasification capacity by 2030. Eligible projects receive financial assistance on their plant and machinery, subject to ceilings for each project, each product and each entity.

In electric mobility, NITI Aayog and World Resources Institute India released the India Electric Mobility Index 2025. It evaluates how States and Union Territories are progressing towards electric mobility on a scale of 0 to 100, using three pillars: transport electrification progress,

charging infrastructure readiness and EV research and innovation. Delhi retained the highest overall position.

A long-pending inter-state project, the Kishau Multipurpose Dam, has also moved forward. It is planned on the Tons River, a tributary of the Yamuna, and several States and Union Territories have reached agreement on its implementation.

Urban statistics were discussed too. The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs told a Parliamentary panel that the criteria for identifying a Census Town may no longer reflect India's changing urbanisation. A Census Town is treated as urban for Census purposes even though it may not be a formally notified urban local body.

Finally, India's foreign exchange reserves reached a record high, a rise linked mainly to inflows through RBI's concessional swap arrangements tied to FCNR(B) deposits.

Q1.

What percentage of the cost of the water component will the Union Government provide as Central Assistance for the Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Up to what percentage of expenditure on plant and machinery will the government provide as financial assistance under the new coal and lignite gasification scheme? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many performance indicators does the India Electric Mobility Index 2025 use to evaluate States and Union Territories?

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many States/UTs are participating in the Kishau Multipurpose Dam Project?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What minimum population must a settlement have to qualify as a Census Town under the criteria introduced for the 1981 Census? (in persons)

Answer: _____

Q6.

After the recent rise, what global rank did India attain in foreign exchange reserves? (ordinal)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What weight, in per cent, does the Transport Electrification Progress pillar carry in the India Electric Mobility Index 2025? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Schemes, Events and Honours

September brought a mix of schemes, events and honours. The country marked International Literacy Day with a national festival that focused on adults who never learned to read. The programme is meant to build basic reading, writing and calculating skills among learners who have passed the age of school.

Water also featured in the news. A major conference on water management brought together experts, officials and delegates to discuss solutions that can withstand a changing climate. The event is a flagship initiative of a central government ministry, and it has been rebranded for the current year.

In cinema, the nation's highest honour is named after a pioneer of Indian films. The award recognises an individual's outstanding contribution to the growth and development of Indian cinema. A veteran actor from Karnataka was selected for the 2024 award and became the second Kannada actor to receive it.

Beauty pageants made headlines too. The Miss World contest crowned a new titleholder from the Dominican Republic at its latest edition, and the next edition has already been planned for a future year in another country. An Indian contestant secured a place among the top forty.

Q1.

In which year was the Dadasaheb Phalke Award instituted?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was Raja Harishchandra, directed by the award's namesake and regarded as India's first full-length feature film, made?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city did the ULLAS Mela mark the conclusion of the International Literacy Day 2026 celebrations?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was India Water Week first conceptualised, before its 2026 rebranding? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which financial year does the implementation period of the ULLAS scheme end? (financial year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which Vietnamese city was the 73rd edition of Miss World held?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which country will host the next Miss World edition, scheduled for 2027?

Answer: _____

Mokha Capture and Red Sea Stakes (TITA)

Yemen's renewed conflict has taken a new turn after the Houthis captured the strategic port city of Mocha, also written as Mokha, on the Red Sea coast. The Houthis are an Iran-aligned armed group in Yemen. Their control now extends further along the western coastline, and government-aligned forces have lost an important coastal position. Mocha is described as a significant development in the renewed conflict.

The Houthis are described as an opposition movement that emerged during the 2000s. Their ideology centres on opposition to Israel and the United States, and they are part of the Iranian-led

Axis of Resistance. Their current leader is Abdul-Malik al-Houthi, and the capital, Sanaa, is currently under Houthi control.

Mocha's location could increase the group's leverage over regional maritime traffic. Oil, commodities and other goods moving between Asia and Europe could be affected by the developments. Global trade, energy security and Red Sea maritime security are all involved in the outcome, while the civil war in Yemen continues. The internationally recognised president, Rashad al-Alimi, leads a government that now faces these new pressures, and its prime minister is Shaea al-Zindani. The recognised government controls only limited areas in the north, and rising jihadist threats from Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula have added to the country's security concerns.

Q1.

In which Yemeni governorate is Mokha located? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How far, in km, is Mokha from the Bab el-Mandeb Strait? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

After Mokha fell, government forces moved south towards which coastal area? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Along with Mokha, the Houthis seized Perim and which other island? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Saudi Arabia shut which pipeline after drone strikes from Iraq? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which strait links the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden? (name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Houthi forces advanced towards which islands in the Red Sea? (name)

Answer: _____

Yemen's North-South Divide (TITA)

Yemen has long been divided between its north and south. The two regions have distinct religious traditions, social structures and systems of governance, and these differences were reinforced by foreign influence and colonial legacies, especially in the south. The Cold War era added another layer, as both regions were tied to outside powers.

Southern discontent has resurfaced repeatedly. A movement continues to demand greater autonomy or independence for southern Yemen, and a separatist council in the south has expanded its influence in parts of the region. The Southern Transitional Council, which seeks autonomy or independence, has recently expanded its influence in Hadramout and Mahra. Opposing that council is a pro-government military bloc, which is closely aligned with the Hadramout tribal alliance and opposes the council separatist agenda.

Yemen's internal divisions therefore remain part of its political landscape. Its north and south have different histories, and the country's politics continues to reflect those differences in the present

day, with several groups competing for influence across the region. Southern discontent and present-day politics cannot be separated from the north-south divide that shaped the country's past. The divisions also influence which outside powers each group receives support from. The council expansion has been noted in recent developments.

Q1.

Which country backed South Yemen before the 1990 unification? (name the country)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did North and South Yemen merge? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did southern leaders attempt secession, leading to a brief civil conflict? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Southern Movement (Al-Hirak) formed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did Ali Abdullah Saleh begin governing North Yemen? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Gulf state backs the Southern Transitional Council? (one word)

Answer: _____

Mukalla Strike and UAE Withdrawal (TITA)

Southern Yemen has been at the centre of recent political and military developments. Saudi officials alleged the shipment contained arms for separatist groups. The state that sent the shipment rejected the allegation, saying the cargo was meant for its own forces and that the claims were unfounded. It has also said its military presence in Yemen is limited to counter-terrorism operations. At the request of the Republic of Yemen, Saudi Arabia had earlier asked that state to withdraw its military elements within 24 hours. The state has said that Yemen's future political structure should be determined by Yemenis themselves. A council in the south seeks autonomy or independence, and it has recently expanded its influence in the region. Opposing it is a pro-government military bloc that receives backing from Saudi Arabia, and the two Gulf states have supported different sides in the south. The council separatist agenda and its foreign backing remain at the centre of the debate about the south, and escalating airstrikes raised risks for personnel in the region. The episode is one of several recent developments in the south.

Q1.

Which port in southern Yemen was struck by Saudi airstrikes? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which UAE port city did the consignment come from? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What did the sending state say the shipment consisted of? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which council in the south seeks autonomy or independence? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The council has recently expanded its influence into Mahra and which other area? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country says its military presence in Yemen is limited to counter-terrorism operations? (one word)

Answer: _____

Court of Arbitration findings: TITA

A ruling from an international Court of Arbitration has placed the Indus Waters Treaty at the centre of a fresh dispute between India and Pakistan. The treaty has governed the sharing of the Indus river system since 1960, and the question now is whether India could suspend it after a security crisis in 2025. The case asks whether a treaty can be set aside on that basis, or whether it keeps applying until the parties end it through a formal agreement.

The tribunal read the treaty as written and tested India's position against the wider law of treaties. It also considered whether the treaty's text deals with the use of force. These points matter because the answer shapes how the treaty's obligations on the Western Rivers are understood. The ruling is therefore a test of how the treaty's text applies to a new situation.

The ruling also touched on the Ratle project, a hydroelectric scheme in Jammu and Kashmir. Interim limits were placed on some work there, and those limits remain linked to a later stage of the dispute.

India has rejected the ruling and does not accept the tribunal's authority over its decisions on the western rivers. Its objections focus on the tribunal's standing and on the path the dispute took before the tribunal was asked to decide it.

Q1.

Under which article of the Indus Waters Treaty is India obliged to let flow the waters of the Western Rivers to Pakistan? (give the article with its number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which 1969 convention did the tribunal apply to hold that the abeyance was not permissible? (short name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is the Court of Arbitration based? (city name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

On which river is the Ratle hydroelectric project located? (river name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Does the treaty contain any provisions dealing with terrorism or the use of force? (answer yes or no)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What term describes India's decision to temporarily suspend the treaty? (one word)

Answer: _____

India's objection to the tribunal: TITA

A recent ruling has pushed the Indus Waters Treaty back into the news, and with it the question of how disagreements under the treaty should be settled. The treaty contains its own dispute-resolution structure, and the current controversy is about whether that structure was followed. One side has rejected the outcome and has challenged the authority of the tribunal that issued it.

The dispute has a history. Parallel processes were opened in the same period, and the institutions that oversee the treaty had to decide how those processes could run side by side. At one point both were paused, and later both were allowed to move forward again.

The tribunal's findings and the response to them have renewed interest in the treaty's design. The question is not only about how water is allocated but also about process, including which step must come before another and which forum has the final word.

India's government has defended its decision on the treaty and says the tribunal has no power to review it. The dispute therefore turns as much on the order of steps as on the water itself. Several steps in the process are described as separate stages, each with its own role.

Q1.

After the Permanent Indus Commission, which body takes up technical differences under India's reading of the treaty? (name the body)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Indian ministry said the Court of Arbitration was constituted contrary to the treaty? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q3.

According to India's government, which institution constituted the Court of Arbitration? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

India's abeyance decision followed which April 2025 terror attack? (place name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

India argues the tribunal lacks jurisdiction over its sovereign decisions and infrastructure projects on which group of rivers? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In 2016, which country initiated proceedings seeking a Court of Arbitration? (country name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Did India take part in the Court of Arbitration proceedings? (answer yes or no)

Answer: _____

Indus river system: TITA

A trans-boundary river system needs rules that every country sharing it can accept. The Indus is one of the most significant examples in South Asia, and its basin is shared by several countries. Its main river rises far to the north, and several large tributaries join it from different directions across the region.

The tributaries have their sources in different places. Some begin in high mountain passes and frozen ice fields, while others come from springs or lakes in the mountains. As they flow, they meet one another at points along the plains, and some of these meeting points lie in Punjab.

Legal thinking about shared rivers developed over several decades. Early work set out principles for the use of water in a shared drainage basin. Later agreements dealt with other concerns, as well as with the wider law governing the non-navigational use of international watercourses.

Not every country has joined the most widely discussed of these agreements. The status of signatures shows which states have accepted the broader framework and which have stayed outside it. The main rivers of the system, including the Jhelum, the Chenab, the Ravi, the Beas and the Satluj, each have their own sources and meeting points.

Q1.

The Indus originates at which glacier near Mount Kailash in Tibet? (name of the glacier)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The Jhelum joins the Chenab at which place in Punjab, Pakistan? (place name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Near which pass do both the Ravi and the Beas have their source region? (name the pass)

Answer: _____

Q4.

The Satluj joins the Indus a little above which town in Punjab, Pakistan? (town name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the UN Watercourses Convention adopted? (four-digit year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Helsinki Convention of 1992 provides a framework for preventing and controlling what, across national borders? (one word)

Answer: _____

Devolution and the Asymmetric UK Framework

Devolution is a feature of the constitutional arrangements of the United Kingdom. Under it, powers move from the central government to institutions below the national level, yet the centre continues to hold ultimate constitutional authority. Three territories of the UK have such institutions: Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland. Their powers are not identical, because the extent and

nature of what each can do differ. For this reason the framework is often described as asymmetric.

Wales has its own legislature, which was created by a law passed in 1998. Scotland's parliament was created by another law of the same year. Money is also part of the picture. The sums given to devolved administrations change according to a formula applied by one central department. Questions about how resources are allocated therefore form part of wider debates on the country's fiscal and constitutional arrangements.

Recently, a law was passed to regulate the domestic market across the UK after the country left the European Union. Its effects on devolved governments have been debated. These are matters that continue to be discussed across the UK. The relationship between Westminster and the devolved administrations is central to this discussion. Different parts of the country have reached different views on these questions.

Q1.

The Welsh legislature created under a 1998 Act of Parliament is now known as what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which 1998 Act of Parliament established the Welsh legislature? (name of the Act)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which formula does the UK Treasury use to set changes in block grant funding for devolved administrations? (name of the formula)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Devolved governments criticised the UK Internal Market Act, 2020 for reducing their ____ autonomy. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the UK Internal Market Act passed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which UK body uses the Barnett Formula to set changes in block grant funding? (name of the body)

Answer: _____

Q7.

UK devolution is described as asymmetric rather than what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Good Friday Agreement and Northern Ireland

The Good Friday Agreement, reached in 1998, was an attempt to bring an end to decades of violence in Northern Ireland. Its main purpose was to create a government in which people with differing views on the region's future would share power. Freedom of movement across the islands was encouraged, and checks along the border were abolished. Decades later, the picture changed. When the United Kingdom left the European Union, Northern Ireland came to share a land border with a neighbouring state that belonged to the EU. Checks were then introduced on trade between Great Britain and Northern Ireland. Several parties in the region opposed these checks, arguing that they weakened Northern Ireland's place within the UK. Political deadlock followed the 2022 election, when a government could not be formed for a time. A new deal was later set out by the UK

Government to address these problems. The arrangements since then have raised questions about the region's constitutional status. Power-sharing and border arrangements remain central to the region's politics. The agreement's provisions still shape these discussions.

Q1.

The Good Friday Agreement ended a conflict in Northern Ireland known by what name? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which party's leader refused to allow government formation after the May 2022 polls in Northern Ireland? (party name; short form accepted)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of the command paper in which the UK Government published a new deal for Northern Ireland?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the agreement, which office holder can call a border poll on Irish reunification? (office title)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which EU member state shares a land border with Northern Ireland? (name of the state)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Good Friday Agreement was signed in which city? (city name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under the agreement, reunification with Ireland may be sought at any time, subject to what? (one word)

Answer: _____

Sanctioning Russia Act: Key Figures

A law named the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 has been enacted in the United States. The measure followed Senate approval and passage in the House of Representatives, and the President then signed it into law. Its main objective is to increase economic pressure on Russia over the war in Ukraine. The Act also extends and strengthens certain sanctions against Iran.

The Act sets out a wide-ranging package aimed at political, financial, energy and commercial networks that help sustain Russia's war. Although it does not single out nations, its criteria place major buyers of Russian oil and gas within scope. India is affected because it remains one of the major buyers of Russian crude. Tariffs can be imposed on the largest purchasers of Russian energy, and on facilitators of Russian oil sanctions evasion.

Relevant purchasers are reassessed at intervals, with the review involving other senior officials. The Act also allows exceptions for countries that import a small share of natural gas from Russia and take significant steps to reduce such imports. The sanctions can be affected if Russia meets conditions tied to ending the war, as set out in the law. The Act is now federal law, which gives it greater legal permanence.

Q1.

How many days is the review cycle for reassessing relevant purchasers? (number of days)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Through which year does the Act extend the Iran Sanctions Act of 1996? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Below what percentage share of natural gas imports from Russia can a country qualify for the exception? (per cent)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many of the largest purchasers of Russian oil and gas can face tariffs under the Act? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which word qualifies the name of the sanctions structure that the Act sets up? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many House members voted in favour of the legislation? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

On which day of September 2026 was the Act signed into law? (day of month)

Answer: _____

Sino-Indian Border: States, UTs and Sectors

The boundary between India and China follows the high Himalayan range, and much of it has not been settled by a final agreement. On the ground, the working line between the two sides is known as the Line of Actual Control. This line is described as a practical boundary, not one that is legally recognised as an international border. It is also described as an effective military border that separates the two sides' controlled areas. The frontier cuts through several Indian states and one Union Territory, and each stretch faces its own terrain and local conditions. Earlier, both countries agreed to principles that committed each side to respect the other's sovereignty and territorial integrity. Their relationship was also marked by a slogan of brotherhood that captured a period of mutual trust. After the 1962 conflict, the Line of Actual Control took its practical form as a ceasefire line. Its status has been a source of repeated tension, including clashes between troops in recent years. For management purposes, the line is divided into sectors so that officials can coordinate their work. Today, both sides manage the frontier through a set of mechanisms that respond to incidents, while the wider boundary question remains unresolved.

Q1.

Which Indian state borders China, Nepal and Bhutan? (name the state)

Answer: _____

Q2.

China refers to part of an Indian state it claims as 'South Tibet'. Which Indian state is this? (name the state)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Indian Union Territory shares a border with China? (name the UT)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian Prime Minister signed the Panchsheel Agreement with China? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Panchsheel Agreement signed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which sector of the LAC covers Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh? (name the sector)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Indian state is surrounded by Jammu & Kashmir, Uttarakhand, Haryana and Punjab? (name the state)

Answer: _____

Border Management Mechanisms and Agreements

The India-China boundary remains unresolved, and the two countries handle the frontier through a set of mechanisms rather than a single settlement. The line runs for 3,488 km along the Himalayan range. Some arrangements are led by senior officials who discuss the long-term question, while others help deal with incidents. Local military commanders have a role at specific points on the ground, where they can meet to talk through friction. At higher levels, talks have been used when standoffs grow serious, to plan steps that reduce tension. Several agreements were concluded over the years, adding rules on the conduct of troops and on military activity near the line. The arrangement has grown over several decades, and each step has added a channel or a rule rather than settling the question. The frontier is also divided into sectors for management purposes, so that each stretch can be discussed separately. The line itself is a practical boundary rather than a legally recognised international border, so these arrangements matter for daily management. Because the frontier is long and varied, managing it is a continuing task for officials on both sides. Together, they show that the dispute is being managed even though it is still pending.

Q1.

Which Chinese President visited India in 1996, when a confidence-building agreement was signed? (name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Indian Prime Minister was visiting China when the 1993 agreement on peace and tranquillity was signed? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Special Representatives mechanism set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination set up? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What are the designated locations where local military commanders meet to address ground-level friction called? (name in full)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which 2005 protocol set procedures for face-to-face encounters between troops? (name it in two words)

Answer: _____

Mercator Projection: Facts and Figures

Turning the round surface of the Earth into a flat map always involves some distortion. Different projections handle this in different ways, and the Mercator design is one of the most familiar. On the Mercator grid, longitudes are evenly spaced, but the gaps between latitudes widen as one moves towards the Poles. This spacing is a deliberate feature of the design, and it keeps the shapes of landmasses locally recognisable. The trade-off is that landmasses far from the Equator appear much larger than they really are, so the amount of exaggeration depends on how far a landmass lies from the Equator. Africa, for example, looks similar in size to Greenland on such a map, even though the two differ greatly in reality. Antarctica is also drawn far larger than its true size. On a standard wall map, India looks like a middleweight beside Scandinavia, which shows how much the grid can change the impression of a country's size. The Equal Earth projection is a newer design, used for thematic maps, that aims to show the whole globe in a more balanced way. Choosing a projection depends on what a map is meant to show, and each design makes its own choices about which features to keep.

Q1.

Gerardus Mercator, who introduced the Mercator projection, was a geographer and cartographer from which region? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many cartographers created the Equal Earth projection? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

At what latitude, in degrees North, does the booklet use to show that India is inflated by only about 16% on the Mercator projection? (in degrees)

Answer: _____

Q4.

According to the comparison table, what is the primary advantage of the Equal Earth projection? (three words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Equal Earth is described as an equal-area projection of which type? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

According to the comparison table, what is the primary advantage of the Mercator projection? (one word)

Answer: _____

Other Projections and Survey of India Facts

Map projections are not a single fixed method, and cartographers have produced many of them over time. Every flat map is a trade-off, because a flat sheet cannot match the curved surface of the globe in every respect. The Winkel Tripel was designed to reduce distortion across area, distance and direction together, instead of perfecting one property at the cost of the others. It belongs to a wider group of compromise designs, which spread errors across several properties rather than concentrating them in one. Major institutions, including a large geographic society and the World Bank, later adopted it for their maps. Such compromise maps are used for general reference and world maps, where a natural-looking view of the whole globe is useful. Choosing a projection depends on the purpose of the map, so a design that suits one task may be poor for another. Accuracy matters in official mapping for a different reason. The Survey of India is a national body that works on official maps, and among its tasks is establishing geodetic reference frameworks, which give surveys a common base. The same survey body also checks how international borders appear on published maps. Maps published in India are also subject to legal rules that control how borders may be shown.

Q1.

In which year was the Winkel Tripel projection created? (in year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which section of the Criminal Law Amendment Act (1961) penalises the publication and distribution of certain maps? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Gall-Peters projection first presented? (in year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Arno Peters, who popularised the Gall-Peters projection, was a historian of which nationality? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The Robinson projection was devised partly to solve which problem, named after a landmass? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Criminal Law Amendment Act (1961) penalises maps that misrepresent India's international borders contrary to what? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which city is the headquarters of the Survey of India located? (one word)

Answer: _____

Status and Powers of the Election Commission (Fill-in)

The Election Commission of India is a permanent, all-India and independent body that conducts elections across the country. Its basic task is to ensure that elections to the Lok Sabha, the Rajya Sabha and the State Legislative Assemblies are free and fair, and it also oversees the elections of the President and the Vice President. Since 1993, the Commission has been a three-member body. It consists of one Chief Election Commissioner and two Election Commissioners, who together carry out its work. The Commission shares responsibility for electoral rolls with the state chief

electoral officers and state election commissions. An electoral roll is the official list of people eligible to vote in a given election within a specific area, and being on that list is a legal requirement for casting a vote. Its work involves preparing voter lists and managing polls, and it also has functions that the Constitution and the courts have helped to define. Because its powers are rooted in the Constitution, the Commission is described as a constitutional body. Its members also enjoy fixed service conditions that cannot be varied to their disadvantage after appointment.

Q1.

A CEC or EC serves for six years or until what age, whichever is earlier? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The CEC and ECs enjoy salary and status equal to a judge of which court? (name of the court)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which power of the ECI covers allocating election symbols? (name the power)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which power of the ECI covers defining constituencies? (name the power)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which legal principle does the Supreme Court say is applied in a flexible and pragmatic manner in electoral matters? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Election Commission of India established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Can a CEC who has completed a term be re-appointed? (answer yes or no)

Answer: _____

The EVM and the VVPAT (Fill-in)

The Electronic Voting Machine, known as the EVM, is an electronic device that records votes in place of the traditional ballot papers and ballot boxes. The machine has been used in elections to the Lok Sabha, State Legislative Assemblies and by-elections, and it has been in use across different parts of the country for several decades. Since it is electronic, votes are stored in the machine rather than being collected and counted manually from paper. A companion system, the Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail, is attached to the EVM and is meant to give voters a way to check their choice. The system is described as an independent unit that works alongside the EVM. The purpose of this arrangement is to increase confidence in the voting process among voters and political parties alike. Courts have also commented on the role of such systems in elections, and several judgments have discussed them. The overall aim is to make the physical record of each vote available for verification. Its use expanded gradually over the following years, and it was extended to elections across the country.

Q1.

In which year was VVPAT first introduced, in the Noksen bye-election in Nagaland? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

After the 2019 Supreme Court ruling, how many EVMs' VVPAT slips per constituency must be counted? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year were VVPATs used in all constituencies of the Lok Sabha elections? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which model of EVM and VVPAT is presently used? (model name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which city is Electronic Corporation of India Ltd based? (city)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was VVPAT first proposed? (year)

Answer: _____

SEMICON India and the Programme: TITA

SEMICON India is a conference and exhibition that showcases India's semiconductor capabilities. It gives the sector one place to display its progress, and each edition is an occasion to present the work done in chip-related fields. The event is staged alongside the national effort to build a domestic base for chips, which the government has pursued through a dedicated programme. Its organisation involves the India Semiconductor Mission, which serves as the nodal body for the schemes in this area. The gathering brings together displays of work from across the sector, which makes it a useful window into the country's chip-related strengths.

The Semicon India Programme is the central scheme behind this effort. Its objective is to establish a complete set of capabilities in the country, running from the creation of designs through to the production and packaging of chips. The programme's work is grouped into several connected areas, and it also covers the training of skilled people and the support of research and new ideas.

Several projects have already been announced, with companies planning facilities in different parts of the country. Some of these projects involve partnerships between Indian companies and overseas firms, and they show how the programme's goals are being turned into physical units. The projects are spread across several states and cover different stages of chip making.

Q1.

In which year was the first edition of SEMICON India held? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the theme of SEMICON India 2026? (quoted phrase)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from the India Semiconductor Mission and the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, which body organises SEMICON India? (short name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

At which New Delhi venue did PM Modi inaugurate SEMICON India 2026? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which programme focus area concerns the training of skilled people? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which Gujarat town is the Tata Electronics semiconductor fab being set up? (one word)

Answer: _____

Reasons behind the MDR framework

The network behind UPI handles a very large number of payments each month, and that volume keeps growing. Growth of this kind places heavy demands on the systems that run the network. Equipment and software must be upgraded regularly, and server capacity must expand as more users join. Customer support also has to be maintained for a large base of users. Fraud and other threats appear as digital payments become more common, so the operators must watch for them constantly. The Merchant Discount Rate framework was introduced to address these demands. It creates a revenue source inside the payment ecosystem. Before the framework, the zero-MDR policy had allowed merchants to accept UPI and RuPay payments without any fee, an arrangement that encouraged digital adoption among small traders and informal sectors. Under the new framework, everyday low-value transactions remain free, and the government and the National Payments Corporation of India have stressed the need to protect small merchants and ordinary users from additional costs. The framework is therefore presented as a way to sustain the network while keeping daily payments affordable for people who use them.

Q1.

Which reason for the framework is linked to revenue supporting technological improvements and new payment solutions? Give one word.

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which reason for the framework is linked to stronger systems against fraud and cyber threats? Give one word.

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which reason says that a revenue mechanism can support the continued operation and expansion of UPI? Give two words.

Answer: _____

Q4.

The framework is meant to reduce dependence on continued ____ funding. Give one word.

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which reason is linked to continuous investment in payment infrastructure and technology? Give two words.

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which reason for the framework is named after the protection it gives to people? Give two words.

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which reason's name begins with 'Support for' and concerns eligible small merchants? Give the two words that follow 'Support for'.

Answer: _____

UPI, MDR and NPCI terms

UPI is used for transfers between individuals and for payments made to merchants. One category of payments is made from a customer to a business, and the booklet explains how fees apply to such payments. The fee charged for handling a digital payment is known by a short form that appears throughout the booklet. The fee falls on the business that receives the money, while the framework for it is designed around a few value slabs. The revenue from these fees stays within the network and helps support its work. Among the countries listed as accepting the system are several in Asia, along with a small number of other nations on different continents. The network is operated by a body whose functions include developing and operating payment systems across the country. Many small businesses and informal sectors were encouraged to adopt digital payments in earlier years, when merchants paid no fee at all. The booklet presents the framework as one that fits into the wider payment ecosystem and protects ordinary users from additional costs. Readers who want to understand the framework should look at its slabs, its exemptions and the reasons behind it.

Q1.

What does the abbreviation MDR stand for? Give the full name.

Answer: _____

Q2.

What does the abbreviation UPI stand for? Give the full name.

Answer: _____

Q3.

What does the abbreviation P2M stand for? Give the phrase with hyphens between the words.

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Middle East nation in the booklet's list of UPI-accepting countries is named by its abbreviation? Give the abbreviation.

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which European nation, other than Greece, is listed as accepting UPI? Give the country name.

Answer: _____

Q6.

The booklet describes UPI as a system that works across different banks and platforms. Which single word describes this quality?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What does the abbreviation NPCI stand for? Give the full name.

Answer: _____

New Delhi Summit Basics

India hosted the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi in 2026, which marked its fourth chairship of the grouping. The chairship ran under the theme 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.' The summit closed with the adoption of a declaration that emphasised

multilateralism and more equitable global governance. Through the year, a series of ministerial and sectoral meetings took place in several Indian cities. Their subjects included urbanisation, energy, transport and the work of chief justices. Several of the year's meetings were held in New Delhi, including the Urbanisation Forum, the Chief Justices' Forum and the Leaders' Summit. The calendar covered more than one state, as the host cities included places in Haryana and Maharashtra. The 2026 calendar, set out in the summit material, ran over several months of the year. The key outcomes were grouped under several headings. These included financial, economic and trade cooperation, taxation and customs cooperation, agriculture and food security, health and medicine, transport, logistics and climate cooperation, security, law and social cooperation, culinary diplomacy, and geopolitical mandates with global governance. The culinary diplomacy heading featured regional products shown during the summit. Earlier Indian chairships took place on several occasions before 2026. Earlier chairships also carried themes of their own.

Q1.

In which year did the BRIC concept emerge? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What edition number was the BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting in 2026? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city was the BRICS Energy Ministers' Meeting held? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did India's chairship host the BRICS summit in Goa? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In what format was India's 2021 chairship summit held? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which BRICS event was held in Mumbai? (name of event)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How was the New Delhi Declaration adopted? (one word)

Answer: _____

Security and Governance: Typed Answers

The security and law outcomes at the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi were set out under one heading. The summit condemned cross-border terrorism, and the outcomes also had items on corruption and the recovery of assets. Labour, social security and culture formed another heading, which included a network linked to workers' rights. Global governance was covered under its own heading, which dealt with reform of international institutions and India's proposals on how the international system should operate. India's framework seeks to move the international system towards a more inclusive model of global partnership. The outcomes also included a culinary diplomacy heading, under which India showcased regional products during the summit. The security heading sat near the end of the outcomes, after the science and health sections. The summit concluded with the New Delhi Declaration, which the outcomes described as emphasising multilateralism. The chairship also featured a series of ministerial and sectoral meetings across several Indian cities. The outcomes ended with a note on the next chairship. Overall, the outcomes

were grouped under headings that covered security, science, finance, health and culture.

Q1.

Which country will host the 19th BRICS Summit in 2027? (country)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year is the 19th BRICS Summit to be held? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many points are in India's roadmap for global governance reform? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country's WTO accession bid did BRICS endorse alongside Iran's? (country)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Besides Ethiopia, which country was backed for expanded representation on the ICAO Council? (country)

Answer: _____

Q6.

BRICS CONNECT's capacity building covers employability and which other area? (name the area)

Answer: _____

SCO structure and timeline

The SCO links a broad group of Eurasian states, with members drawn from Central Asia, South Asia, China, Russia and Iran. Its agenda is wide and covers security questions, economic and connectivity projects, political dialogue, and exchanges between cultures and peoples. Leaders gather at an annual summit, and the host role moves to a different member state as the chairmanship rotates. Governance is spread across several bodies, and each has a distinct area of work. The organisation marked its 25th anniversary in 2026, and its theme for that year stressed sustainable peace, development and prosperity. Membership has grown in stages since the early years, with new countries joining at different times. The organisation's cooperation is organised around clear goals, including trust among members, trade and connectivity, and cultural exchange. Taken together, these features describe a platform that brings governments from several parts of the continent into a common framework for cooperation. Its stated objectives include strengthening mutual trust, good-neighbourliness and mutual support on issues of security. The organisation also promotes people-to-people exchange in fields such as culture, education and science. Its cooperation extends to transport and digital economy, as well as environmental protection. Its work on energy is also part of its agenda.

Q1.

Which Uzbek city is home to the Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) of the SCO?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did India and Pakistan become full members of the SCO?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which SCO body handles economic and developmental cooperation?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city was the SCO formally established on 15 June 2001?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the SCO's permanent administrative body?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which two countries are observer states of the SCO?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What does the acronym RATS stand for within the SCO?

Answer: _____

India's SCO ties and outreach

India's SCO engagement sits within a broader approach to Eurasia, where access and connectivity matter. Central Asia is landlocked, so institutional links with the region carry particular weight. Energy is another part of the picture, with long-term access to key resources treated as a strategic concern. India's approach also includes cultural outreach aimed at building people-centric ties. The grouping's stated aims include peace, security, stability, economic cooperation and cultural exchange in the region. Digital governance is another area where India's rights-based approach sits in tension with the grouping's focus on data surveillance. Some frictions in the region involve the close ties between two neighbouring countries, and such issues can slow down projects. Practical progress on payment arrangements and transport corridors has been slower than the size of the grouping might suggest. The SCO allows issue-based alignment, so partners can cooperate on specific questions while differing on others. The grouping's agenda covers security, economic and connectivity cooperation, political dialogue, and cultural and people-to-people exchanges. Yet cooperation continues on several fronts, including energy partnerships and green development. The grouping's wider agenda also covers energy, transport, digital economy and environmental protection. India's commitment to peace and stability is stated clearly in its participation, which emphasises dialogue and diplomacy for resolving disputes.

Q1.

Which port, together with the INSTC, reduces dependence on Pakistan-controlled transit for European and Central Asian trade?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the first edition of the World Nomad Games held?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which 2012 declaration conceived the World Nomad Games?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Whose register of good safeguarding practices recognises the Nomad Games initiative?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the traditional Kyrgyz game listed in the Nomad Games sports programme?

Answer: _____

Q6.

India refuses to join which initiative because CPEC passes through disputed territories?

Answer: _____

Arctic Council: Typed Answer

The Arctic has moved up the international agenda as melting ice opens new maritime corridors, including the Transpolar Sea Route. These routes could reduce travel time between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans, lower fuel and shipping costs, and bypass the Panama and Suez canals. Great powers are competing for influence in the region, and China describes itself as a near-Arctic state. Russia has heavily militarised its Arctic coastline, while the United States regards Greenland as central to countering both. Greenland lies between North America and Europe, a position that makes it significant for monitoring naval movements in the North Atlantic. Pituffik Space Base, formerly known as Thule Air Base, is a US facility for monitoring potential missile threats from Russia, China and North Korea. Denmark's firm stance highlights the tension between territorial sovereignty and the strategic ambitions of major powers. The Arctic Council is a forum through which countries discuss the region's environment and development. Its members are the countries whose territory lies inside the Arctic area, and countries from outside the region also take part in its work. Denmark has indicated that the arrangement could support a sustained NATO role in Greenland and the wider Arctic. The Council also has a secretariat, which the booklet mentions in its coverage of the body.

Q1.

In which year was the Arctic Council established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Through which declaration was the Arctic Council established? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

How often, in years, does the Arctic Council's chairmanship alternate? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did India become an observer of the Arctic Council? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which country chaired the Arctic Council from 1996 to 1998? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the Arctic Council's main focus? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What kind of platform is the Arctic Council? (one word, hyphenated form accepted)

Answer: _____

India's Dimension Scores

India's overall gender parity score in the 2026 report is 64.5%, and the booklet compares it with a global average. The country's performance differs sharply across the four dimensions. Education is its strongest area, and the booklet says India has attained near-complete parity between boys and girls in secondary and tertiary enrolment. Health and survival is also close to parity. Economic

participation and political empowerment are much weaker. Women's share among professional and technical workers has nearly doubled since 2006, which shows some progress in the workforce. However, few women reach the top. The booklet notes low representation in leadership, with few women among chief executives and board members in Indian corporates. In the political sphere, women hold a small share of seats in the Lok Sabha, and their share of ministers has fallen from an earlier peak. Among the booklet's figures for the workforce, women hold a notable share of professional roles, but few hold the most senior positions. Women are also underrepresented in senior leadership and managerial positions. The booklet notes that gains in education and health have not yet translated into the economic and political dimensions. In the Lok Sabha, women's share in 2024 is below their share in 2019. The overall picture is one of progress in some areas and persistent gaps in others.

Q1.

What per cent of board members in Indian corporates are women?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What per cent of CEOs in Indian corporates are women?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is India's score in economic participation and opportunity, in per cent?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is India's score in health and survival, in per cent?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What per cent of professional and technical workers in India are women, according to the booklet?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What was women's share in the Lok Sabha in 2019, in per cent?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is India's score in political empowerment, in per cent?

Answer: _____

Government Schemes for Women and Girls

Several programmes aim to improve outcomes for girls and women. Beti Bachao Beti Padhao targets the falling child sex ratio and champions girls' survival, safety and schooling. Vigyan Jyoti is a flagship scheme that empowers meritorious schoolgirls to shine in STEM fields. Pradhan Mantri Jan-Dhan Yojana supports women's autonomy through financial access, and women have opened large numbers of bank accounts under it. The National Health Mission aims to deliver affordable, quality healthcare to India's most vulnerable. Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana offers maternity benefits to pregnant and lactating women across India. Maternal health programmes have reduced the maternal mortality rate. Unpaid work is another part of the picture. Women spend many hours each day on household chores, and the booklet estimates the economic value of this unpaid work in lakh crore. Female literacy remains lower than male literacy, and a large share of girls in the 15 to 18 age group are outside school. Despite rising participation, most women remain in informal, low-paid work. Workplace safety concerns and inadequate childcare remain major hurdles for women at work. The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam mandates representation for

women in legislatures. The booklet also notes that many government programmes face setbacks due to poor outreach and weak execution, especially in remote and rural areas.

Q1.

What is the estimated economic value of women's unpaid domestic work, in lakh crore?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What per cent of girls aged 15 to 18 are not in school?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many crore women have Jan Dhan bank accounts?

Answer: _____

Q4.

From what level did the maternal mortality rate fall to 97?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the National Health Mission introduced?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which department runs the Vigyan Jyoti scheme?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What per cent is female literacy in India, according to the booklet?

Answer: _____

Swachh Vayu Diwas Short Answer Quiz

Swachh Vayu Diwas is an occasion that draws attention to clean air and to the measures taken against air pollution. It is observed alongside an international day that the United Nations General Assembly created to strengthen awareness and international action against air pollution. The occasion is also used to recognise progress, and awards are presented to cities and wards.

The National Clean Air Programme is a national-level strategy that addresses air pollution through coordinated interventions across sectors. It covers non-attainment cities as well as million-plus cities. A non-attainment city is one that has failed to comply with national ambient air quality standards over a specified assessment period.

Progress under the programme is reviewed through the Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan, an annual assessment of cities. The assessment looks at road dust management, solid waste management, vehicular emissions, industrial emissions, construction and demolition waste, commercial sources, and public awareness and outreach. Cities are evaluated on key parameters that cover air quality, action plans and institutional capacity.

Cities are grouped by population into three categories. The first covers cities above 10 lakh people, the second covers cities between 3 and 10 lakh, and the third covers cities below 3 lakh. Rankings are announced separately for each category, so cities are compared with others of similar size.

Q1.

On which date was Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026 observed?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the UN General Assembly designate the International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Swachh Vayu Diwas is India's observance of which international day? (name of the day)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the 2026 theme of the International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies? (phrase)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which ministry organised Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which edition of the Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan Awards was presented on Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026? (ordinal number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Across how many key parameters are cities evaluated in the Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan? (number)

Answer: _____

Pollution Control Tools and Laws Short Answer Quiz

India uses a mix of monitoring tools, field measures and legal provisions to tackle air pollution. The National Air Quality Index communicates air quality status in terms that are easy for people to understand, and it is a tool for effective communication with the public. SAFAR, the System of Air Quality and Weather Forecast and Research, monitors city-wide and localised air quality in Indian metropolises.

Field measures also address pollution from farms. Machines such as the Turbo Happy Seeder are used in the fields, and a bio-decomposer is used to turn crop residue into manure. Emergency action is taken under the Graded Response Action Plan, a set of measures designed to prevent further deterioration of air quality. Vehicle emission standards have been implemented nationwide to reduce vehicular emissions. Both the Turbo Happy Seeder and the Pusa Bio-Decomposer are field-level tools that deal with crop residue.

The legal base includes the Air Act, the Water Act and the Environment Protection Act, which are key pollution control regulations. The Constitution also links the environment to a fundamental duty of citizens, and it has been interpreted to protect the right to a healthy environment. Monitoring, field measures, emergency action and legal provisions together make up the framework described in the booklet.

Q1.

In which year was the National Air Quality Index introduced? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which institute developed the Pusa Bio-Decomposer? (name of the institute)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Within how many days does the Pusa Bio-Decomposer turn crop residue into manure? (days, as a range)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which ministry runs SAFAR, the System of Air Quality and Weather Forecast and Research? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which Article of the Constitution was Clause (g) inserted by the 42nd Amendment (1976)? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Environment Protection Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was the Graded Response Action Plan introduced? (year)

Answer: _____

Reading Satellite Orbits

An orbit is the curved path a satellite follows around Earth under the influence of gravity. Different orbits suit different missions, and the orbit a satellite uses determines the kind of work it can do. Earth orbits are classified by altitude, by inclination and by shape. Inclination is the tilt of an orbit relative to the Equator, and shape refers to whether an orbit is circular or elliptical. Some families lie close to the planet, while others lie far above it. Navigation systems also rely on satellites placed in one of these families.

The lowest family is often used for Earth observation and communication, and it suits large constellations of satellites. Low communication latency is a key feature of this family. Crewed space stations also operate in this closer region. Within the lowest family, specialised sub-types exist for particular purposes. Each family is linked to particular mission applications.

A middle family lies farther away than the lowest family. The highest family, known as geosynchronous, is defined by the timing of a satellite's revolution relative to the planet's spin. A special member of this family appears to hang above one place on the ground, which makes it useful for watching the same region continuously.

Q1.

What is the approximate upper altitude limit, in km, of Low Earth Orbit?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the lower end, in minutes, of the orbital period range given for Low Earth Orbit?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Name the European navigation system that the booklet cites as an example of a Medium Earth Orbit system (one word).

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Low Earth Orbit sub-type enables very high-resolution observations but experiences greater atmospheric drag? (name the sub-type)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the approximate altitude, in km, of Geosynchronous Orbit?

Answer: _____

Q6.

A geosynchronous orbit's period equals 23 hours, 56 minutes and how many seconds? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which orbit family does the booklet describe as offering wider coverage with moderate latency? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Arms Control and Wildlife Trade Treaties

The UN Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons is an arms-control framework that aims to restrict or prohibit weapons considered to have particularly harmful or indiscriminate effects. Countries meeting in Geneva recently reached a working definition of lethal autonomous weapons systems, commonly called killer robots. Such systems can identify and attack targets with limited or no meaningful human intervention. The Convention is commonly known as the Inhumane Weapons Convention, and India is a State Party to it.

The Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora, known as CITES, regulates international trade in endangered wild species. It is legally binding but does not override national laws, and its Conferences of the Parties review its decisions every two to three years. Its Secretariat functions under the UN Environment Programme. Parties appoint authorities for permits and scientific advice, and CITES species are listed by conservation status and trade sensitivity. India is among its members.

Ozone protection is governed by a separate set of agreements. The Vienna Convention was the first global treaty recognising ozone depletion. A landmark later agreement led to a near-complete phase-out of controlled ozone-depleting substances. The Kigali Amendment, adopted in 2016, followed as a further step in this framework.

Q1.

How many countries reached a consensus on a working definition of lethal autonomous weapons systems under the UN Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the UN Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons adopted?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Vienna Convention adopted?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Montreal Protocol adopted?

Answer: _____

Q5.

The Kigali Amendment (2016) mandates the phase-down of which group of chemicals?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did India become a Party to CITES?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which US city was CITES formally signed?

Answer: _____

Tulu, Electoral Bonds and Standard Time

The PM Vishwakarma scheme completed three years of implementation in September 2026, supporting traditional artisans with skill training and collateral-free loans.

Tulu is a Dravidian language spoken mainly along India's south-western coast, in the Tulunadu region of Karnataka and parts of Kasaragod district in Kerala. Its script, Tigalari, is a Southern Brahmic script. Before the States Reorganisation Act, 1956, Tulu-speaking coastal areas were associated with the Madras Presidency. They later became part of a unified Mysore State, which was subsequently renamed.

The Karnataka government has now granted Tulu the status of additional administrative language in the state. The decision followed the recommendations of a committee constituted to examine the status of Tulu and Tuluva culture.

In *Association for Democratic Reforms v. Union of India*, the Supreme Court struck down the Electoral Bond Scheme. Political parties are registered with the Election Commission under the Representation of the People Act, 1951, and registered parties must submit contribution reports.

Indian Standard Time is also being formalised. The Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026 make IST the single mandatory time reference for official purposes, and the national time standard is maintained using highly precise atomic clocks. The rules also promote the use of NavIC and indigenous timing infrastructure.

Q1.

Up to which financial year does the PM Vishwakarma scheme run?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the Supreme Court strike down the Electoral Bond Scheme in *ADR v. Union of India*?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which Section of the Representation of the People Act, 1951 are political parties registered with the Election Commission?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the unified Mysore State renamed Karnataka?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which Article of the Constitution can a State Legislature adopt Hindi, or one or more languages in use in the State, as its official language?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Who headed the committee constituted in 2023 to examine the status of the Tulu language?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which institution is the custodian of India's national time standard?

Answer: _____

Telescopes, Orangutans and Awards

NASA's Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope has been launched to study dark energy and exoplanets. It is a next-generation flagship observatory designed to complement the Hubble and James Webb space telescopes. The telescope is meant to investigate major questions concerning cosmic expansion and galaxy evolution.

Five young orangutans were rescued in Odisha and later moved to a zoological park. Orangutans are arboreal, spending much of their lives in trees. They are not native to India, and their natural range is restricted to tropical forests of Borneo and Sumatra. International commercial trade in orangutans is prohibited under CITES.

World Rhino Day is observed on 22 September to raise awareness about conservation of the world's five remaining rhinoceros species. The Greater One-Horned Rhino is the largest of these species and is concentrated in Kaziranga National Park. Conservation efforts in India include the National Rhino Conservation Strategy, launched in 2019.

The National Film Awards recognise films and cinematic writing and are announced by the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. The President of India presents the awards at a formal ceremony. The awards cover works produced in different Indian languages and regions, and the latest awards honour films produced in the 2024 calendar year.

Q1.

In which year were the National Film Awards established?

Answer: _____

Q2.

On which rocket was NASA's Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope launched?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city's zoological park were the rescued orangutans moved?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which Odisha district were the five young orangutans rescued?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the scientific name of the Bornean orangutan?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which Indian state is Kaziranga National Park located?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Hindi film won the Best Feature Film award in the National Film Awards for films of 2024?

Answer: _____

Upper Bhadra Project Facts

A trial run of the Upper Bhadra Project is the lead item in the governance section of the September 2026 current affairs compilation. The trial carried water from the Bhadra Reservoir to Gonur Lake, which is situated in Chitradurga district. The booklet treats this as the point at which the project begins its operational phase. The development is described as meeting a need that had been pending for a long time: a dependable water supply for parts of central Karnataka. The same governance section contains a proposal under Article 371 for Ladakh, which is listed after the Upper Bhadra item. The economy section of the same compilation carries an item on India's national accounts. The booklet page with these items is headed September 2026 and carries the label Topic in News. The Bhadra item is the first item on that page. Each item in the compilation is placed under a subject heading, and the booklet uses the heading names governance, economy, environment and awards. The Bhadra item also has a set of bullet points about the river and its course, which the compilation lists as separate points from the trial run. The compilation's economy item is set out in its own list of points, separate from the governance item.

Q1.

Through which canal did the trial-run water travel from Bhadra Reservoir to Gonur Lake? (name of canal)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The Upper Bhadra Project is the first Karnataka irrigation project to receive which status from the Union Government? (status name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which mountain range does the Bhadra River originate? (range)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Near which peak does the Bhadra River originate? (peak)

Answer: _____

Q5.

At which place does the Bhadra River join the Tunga River? (place)

Answer: _____

Q6.

The Tungabhadra River is a tributary of which river? (river)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Into which body of water does the Krishna river system ultimately drain? (body of water)

Answer: _____

Ladakh Proposal Details

A proposal for Ladakh appears in the governance section of the September 2026 current affairs compilation. The item says that a new chapter under Article 371 would set up a Special Constitutional Framework for Ladakh. The framework is expected to include a legislative institution at the Union Territory level. The item also says that the institution's expected powers concern matters that are particularly important to the region. The item notes that other areas of legislative authority for Union Territories may also be part of the proposal. The Ladakh item is the second entry under the governance heading on its page. The economy heading on the same page carries an item on India's national accounts. The page is headed September 2026 and carries the label Topic in News. The compilation sorts its items under headings such as governance, economy, environment and awards. Each entry is written as a short list of points beneath its heading. The booklet uses the word proposed in its heading for this item. The item was printed in the September 2026 edition of the compilation, which covers news for that month. Its page number appears at the foot of the page. The text on the page is arranged in sections, one for each heading.

Q1.

Which ministry proposed the new chapter under Article 371 for Ladakh? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Other legislative areas applicable to Union Territories under which article may also form part of the proposal? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

The proposed Union Territory level institution is envisaged as what kind of legislative body? (phrase)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In the item's list of expected powers, which area comes immediately after Local Culture and Traditions? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which item on the same booklet page comes immediately before the Ladakh entry? (name of item)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Besides forests and environment, which other broad area is the last in the item's list of expected powers? (two words)

Answer: _____

National Accounts Series Facts

The economy heading in the September 2026 current affairs compilation has a single entry on national accounts. The entry describes India's revised National Accounts Series, which was

released by a government statistics ministry. The revision introduces several methodological changes, which the entry lists in a short set of points. Among its aims, the revision seeks to incorporate structural changes in the economy. It also seeks to use improved and newer data sources and to update statistical methodologies. The entry describes a systematic framework for measuring an economy's activity. The item on the Upper Bhadra Project sits under the governance heading on the same booklet page. A further governance entry on that page concerns a proposed constitutional framework for a Union Territory. The compilation groups its items under headings such as governance, economy, environment and awards. The next booklet page opens with an environment item on India's first Blue Bond. The page is headed September 2026 and carries the label Topic in News. The national accounts entry is presented as a short list of points beneath its heading. The booklet's running header names the AILET Corner series. The item on the revised series is set in the economy section of the compilation.

Q1.

Which ministry released the revised National Accounts Series? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The revised series adopts which financial year as its new base year? (financial year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which deflation method is adopted for Manufacturing Gross Value Added in the revision? (method name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which system are the revised estimates broadly prepared in line with? (name or abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

National accounts give a framework for measuring an economy's production, income, expenditure, consumption, investment, saving and one further aspect. What is that aspect? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which item on the same booklet page comes immediately before the national accounts entry? (name of item)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What term describes the estimates that more accurately reflect the contemporary economy under the revision? (two words)

Answer: _____